

Player notes

Character Notes

1. Gil (Oliver) Bard Half-Elf
2. Raven (Kuba) Wizard Astral Elf
3. Kaelen (Yug) Fighter Human
4. Raeles (Qaddaffi) Ranger Elf
5. Idaho (Alex) Cleric Dwarf
6. Ignael (Nick) Paladin (oathbreaker) Dragon Born

Gil met Ignael while Gil's mother was visiting Ignael's clan

Kaelen saved Gil when Gil was caught during a failed heist but Kaelen saved him

Raven's mother sword was forged by the tato family

Stronghold notes

BARD:

Stronghold Actions On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), the bard takes a stronghold action with one of the following effects. The bard must be in the same hex or province as their stronghold and cannot use the same effect again until after a short rest. • Until initiative count 20 on the next round, all inspiration dice produce their maximum result when rolled, followed by the sounding of a two-note chord: one root note and another a fifth higher than the root. • A three-piece band arrives singing your praises. Until initiative count 20 on the next turn, enemies make saving throws against your magic by rolling three d20s and using the worst of the three. The band has exceptionally good rhythm and world-class lute fingering, and the singer has an unusually high voice. • You regain all inspiration dice

Class Feature Improvement: Encouraging Inspiration While an ally has unspent inspiration their proficiency bonus increases by +1. This applies to a number of inspiration dice equal to your stronghold level, after which you must take an extended rest to refresh this ability

CLERIC:

Stronghold Actions On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), the cleric takes a stronghold action to cause one of the following effects. The cleric must be in the same hex or province as their stronghold, and can't use the same effect two rounds in a row: • All enemies within 30 feet must succeed on a Constitution saving throw or suffer the effects of the contagion spell. • Shafts of golden light stab down from the sky, penetrating walls and ceilings. The beams target all undead, demons, and devils within 60 feet of you, even those hidden or invisible. Targets must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be annihilated. • You and all allies in the stronghold recover all Hit Dice and gain 30 temporary hit points.

Class Feature Improvement: Manifest Divinity When using your Channel Divinity class feature, all allies within 30 feet regain 3d8 hit points. You can do this a number of times equal to your stronghold level, after which you must take an extended rest to refresh this ability.

FIGHTER

YUGS STORY

In the resplendent annals of the Kingdom of Aethelgard, few names once shone with the luster of Sir Kaelen. He was not merely a knight; he was the realm's iron spine, the King's own shadow wrought in shining steel. To see him upon the field, his white cloak billowing, was to know that justice had arrived—swift, honorable, and unwavering. He was the Paragon of the Kingsguard, a man whose morals were accounted as unimpeachable as the mountains themselves. The King himself praised Kaelen as the finest blade ever to serve the throne. Yet, it is often the brightest lights that are forced to cast the deepest shadows. Three winters past, Sir Kaelen rode on a solitary patrol to the distant valley hamlet of Oakhaven. He found a silence there that chilled the soul. The village had unearthed something ancient in the mines—a magical pestilence from a forgotten age. It was a contagion so virulent it spread not merely by touch, but by proximity; an airborne death with a hundred percent fatality rate. Kaelen recognized the signs from forbidden texts. There was no cure. There was no time. If a single soul left that valley—if a merchant, a traveler, or a fleeing child crossed the pass—the entire kingdom would be a graveyard within a fortnight. And so, the realm's most moral knight was forced to commit its greatest atrocity. To save a million lives, duty demanded he extinguish two hundred. With tears frozen beneath his stoic visor, Sir Kaelen barred the gates. He became the executioner of the innocent. He moved through the village, delivering the King's mercy with a heavy blade to men, women and children he had sworn to protect, before putting the entire valley to the torch to ensure the magical plague died with its hosts. When the royal vanguard arrived, drawn by the pillar of smoke, they found their greatest champion standing amidst the ashes of a massacre. The King, a man of blinding idealism and gentle heart, demanded reasons for this butchery. But Kaelen looked upon his liege and knew the truth would destroy him. The King would have tried to save those villagers, and in his mercy, he would have doomed them all. To protect his King's conscience, Sir Kaelen chose silence. He accepted the brand of a madman and a murderer. He allowed his golden reputation to be shattered so that the realm might survive unbroken. Stripped of his rank and banished on pain of death, he walked away from the only life he had ever known. Now, he wanders distant lands, a knight without a lord, his shining armor scuffed and cloaked in burlap. His skill with the blade remains peerless, yet the man behind the steel is fractured. The ghosts of Oakhaven cling to him. While he will still strike down monsters and beasts with righteous fury, when his blade turns toward a fellow humanoid—be they elf, dwarf, or man; bandit or soldier—his hand trembles. For when he raises his sword for a killing blow against a person, he sees not an enemy, but the terrified faces of the families in Oakhaven, and he cannot bring himself to be the butcher again.

KUBAS STORY

The First Message

One dream stands out.

Raven finds an old journal.

Every page is blank except one.

Written in silver ink:

"Not all who wander are lost, Raven.

Some are being guided."

When Raven wakes up:

The sentence remains written somewhere nearby.

Perhaps in a notebook.

Perhaps on a loose scrap of parchment.

Perhaps appearing briefly in moonlight.

Why Sehanine Chooses Raven

Not because Raven is powerful.

Not because Raven is destined.

Because Raven keeps moving forward.

Sehanine values curiosity.

Discovery.

The willingness to step into uncertainty.

In many ways Raven embodies her ideals without realizing it.

Later Relationship

Eventually Raven may learn:

Sehanine has quietly watched over countless travelers throughout history.

She rarely grants great miracles.

She offers something subtler.

A light in the darkness.

A hint at the crossroads.

A dream when one is needed most.

Unlike gods who demand worship, Sehanine simply walks beside those willing to seek their own path.

And one night, perhaps after a particularly difficult choice, Raven finally reaches the end of one of those moonlit dream roads.

For the first time, the figure ahead turns around.

And Sehanine smiles.

"You've come farther than you think."

That moment could become Raven's first true divine encounter, making it feel personal and earned rather than a god suddenly appearing out of nowhere.

The Chitris began as a traveling couple, a fierce pair of Astral Elves who took on many treacherous battles as they searched for ways to get closer to divinity. Soveliss Chitri was a big elven man with defined muscular features, longer dark hair he tended to tie back in a pony-tail, and fierce glowing green eyes. Wielding his family's long bow and a dagger he took off the corpse of a Githyanki trooper when he was still a young boy, his onslaught of many troublesome creatures made his name was spoken of fondly in the planets he'd inhabit for relatively short durations while traveling with a crew on a spelljammer. Quillathe Chitri was a lean, tall elven woman with white hair that flowed to her waist, and drastically bright blue eyes that pierced the mental fortitude of many of her foes. Quick on her feet and with her blade, she elegantly danced through her enemies with a white bladed sword whose craftsman ship would stun the finest of smiths. Her enchantments gave it the slightest purple hue, a light that would foretell the death of whoever stood before it. She was beloved in her community, and eventually met Soveliss. The

two saw one another, decided they were perfectly suited for one another and disembarked on a spelljammer many years later on their pursuits of even closer divinity.

These plans were put on pause for a short while when the Chitri family welcomed three elven children on their spelljammer to the Astral Plane. The eldest was Erevan, a strong and charming boy who inherited his father's skill with varieties of bows. As a young boy he would venture with his father to hone his talent and follow in his footsteps. The middle child was Mialee, a silent yet curious little girl who loved exploration. She would keep herself very close to her mom frequently, always listening to her stories and lessons. The youngest of them all, was Silaqui, the most wild and out going of the three. All three of these siblings held their familial connections very closely to their hearts, later expanding this care to any friends they would make as they matured. Erevan grew stronger, more diligent, and chose to narrow his bowman-ship proficiency to short bows. Once he was of age, around 20 years, he would go with his father to hunt and to fend off slaad, githyanki, and other problems that only measured up to mild inconveniences as Erevan became quick on his feet like his mother and as precise as a laser like his father. Even little Silaqui took interest in some small knives and picked up some training of her own, developing a rather wild style of combat. Mialee, however, leaned towards more peaceful things such as the reading or some forms of art. Of course violence wasn't avoidable so she did have to learn how to act in defense. She chose to tap into the powers within and cast minor spells. A rather big shocker to her parents and also a bit concerning since they didn't know much else about such things other than what every Astral Elf can do. Erevan, holding great care for his younger siblings, kept their interests in mind and on his ventures would grab items that could benefit their development. For Mialee, it would be letters, books, and on very rare

instances, some scrolls. For Sialqui he'd get cool blades he'd find, to which she'd slash wildly around her in excited fury.

Countless years later, the spelljammer was swarmed. The first wave of oncoming enemies were of slaadi, a significantly larger amount than what any of them were used to fighting in small groups. Even Soveliss showed a sign of faltering confidence as he pulled an arrow and knocked it back. Arrows flew, clubs rampaged, swords clashed, and blood spilled in a catastrophic routine of red and silver. Erevan shot arrow after arrow at blinding speeds, covering his younger sisters with ounce of strength he had. Sialqui dashed through enemies like a rabid animal with two blades in hand attempting to support Erevan from closer targets. Mialee at this point could only cast minor illusions to stall what felt to be an impending end. When the dust settled, the battle was won but everyone was severely weakened. Soveliss stood with tattered clothes, Erevan slumped over holding the more severe wounds. Quillathe looked distraught, seeing her family in such a state and her precious children in agony. Silaqui held back tears to not distress her family any further. But it wasn't over, more fiends started to board the ship, this time it was a whole separate group but they were just as bloodthirsty. Soveliss wordlessly grabbed his dagger and charged the closest enemies, sending them off the ship. His movements weren't as sharp and his speed has considerably dropped. Quillathe went to support him but an arm wrapped around her neck from behind and another fiend stabbed her arm that held the sword. Erevan's fury resurged a new found energy and he lunged at the attackers. Jamming his last arrow through a fiends head, twisting it, and ripping it out. As he turned his attention to the one holding his mother, he gets bodied by another fiend. His father yells as he tackles it off his son, getting back up on his knees and tossing his dagger at the head of the restricting fiend. Quillathe drops to her knees, and as they look at eachother at eye level her head seems to tilt. It

hits the ground, yet her body stayed kneeling pointing at the paralyzed Soveliss. A horde of fiends charge past her and to the daughters. Mialee grabs her sister by the hand and retreats from the oncoming horde. Erevan tearidly yanks Soveliss up and they run after the sisters. As a fiend closes in on Mialee she desperately tries to conjure an illusion but her panic and sorrow prevented her from doing anything. Silaqui rips from her sisters hand and clutches the daggers from her waist. In tears, screaming at the attackers and wildly hacking at the bodies. She holds her own but not without sustaining increasingly more injuries. Erevan and Soveliss throw punches and kick with all their might, yanking weapons form the bodies of fallen fiends and discarding them into the bodies of whichever soul dared to approach next. This went on for what felt like an eternity. Thankfully it did come to an end, the spelljammer being riddled with corpses and among them the decapitated body of Quillathe Chitri. The ship started to approach a planet, and as they did the third wave started making its appearance.

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Mialee dragged her sister off the ship. She hugs her, crying profusely and lays her down next to Soveliss. Erevan holds his last remaining sibling tightly. They were lost, the spelljammer was in ruins and their clothes looked as though they've been mauled. Erevan gets up and urges his sister to do so as well, acknowledging they need to keep a move on. Mialee walks with him, holding him tightly like she used to do with her mom when she was younger. Her mind replaying her father flailing the family bow violently. She recalls the sound of it snapping in half as he broke it over the fiend that loomed over her wounded sister. Half of it flying off and landing at her feet, with “-itri” being written on that half of the handle. She recalls the sound of a Githyanki

blade tearing through her fathers chest and his voice gargling till he fell silent in front of Silaqui. She stared as he yanked his blade out, lifted it, and brought it down on her. Mialec recalls her sister didn't say or do anything, her eyes closed and never opened again. All while Mialec threw whatever she could, hit however she knew, and attempted to cast every thing she ever read about.

When they finally approach some sort of civilization, the inhabitants stare at them. Some in shock, some in terror, while others seemed to eye them in a contemplative manner. Erevan didn't know what to make of it, brushing it off as people being scared of blood soaked visitors. He couldn't blame them. Mialec tugged at the remains of his shirt, as he looked at her, she pointed to a board that was stationed outside of what looked to be a tavern. The posters on the board had the names of all their family members, with a picture above it, and a number at the top of the page. Erevan couldn't read this language, but he knew what a bounty looked like. He started paying closer attention to the people staring at them and that's when he realized there's more and more people. As if they were getting swarmed.

Erevan grabs his sister's hand and bolts out the way they came, exclaiming that they will most definitely not find shelter in that place. He raced back to where they left their family hoping they could lay them to rest. But when they got there, all of their heads were missing. He fell to his knees, and Mialec stood there. She looks off to the side and notices there's figures walking away from their location. Her feelings getting the best of her logic, she dashed at them. Erevan notices his sister bolting, what she's bolting too, and follows after her. As they ran, they noticed along the ground was a trail of drops. The dots all connected, and with it came a roaring hatred and anger at the sheer filth of it all. Mialec tunnel visioned, she saw her target, stopped in her tracks, and raised her hand. She recalled her desperate attempts at casting this spell when practicing throughout the years, and the even more desperate attempts when her whole family

was on the line. With her tuning out the world around her, she glared at the back of one of the figures head, and she says “fire-bolt.” A beam of flames erupts from her hand and obliterates the targets head. His compatriot jumps back in shock straight into the arms of an infuriated Erevan, who promptly grabs him by the head and snaps his neck. Erevan looked back at his sister, giving her a feint smile to try and encourage her. But they both were way past trying to feel better. They look at the blood soaked bags on the ground, knowing what they contained. Mialeee curses everything, and while remembering her parents only every went on these stupid journeys was to get closer to divinity, her resentment to such ideals grows.

Mialeee read countless things over the past couple years, and her brother became very good at piloting their own spelljammer. Granted, they stole it from a bunch of fiends who tried to claim their bounty but in their eyes it was well deserved. Mialeee became much better at casting some minor spells, but her books and lack of magical encounters can only take her so far. Over time she learned how to repair some minor dents and fractures in their clothing and gear. Often times that’d be the only way she could support her brother without putting herself in danger. Erevan became a lot more protective of her, but he still wanted to fulfill their parents dream and get even closer to divinity. In that regard the siblings didn’t see eye to eye, but they avoided the topic so they wouldn’t argue with one another. It didn’t help that Erevan’s attitude has changed drastically. He’s become very cold to people who aren’t his sister, using intimidation as opposed to his natural charisma like he used to to get information or strike deals. Mialeee daydreams about going to some far away land and going on a journey further away from gods and false promises.

Maybe then she could make some friends, form a family that doesn't collapse. Mialee doesn't know how to leave the Astral Realm on her own, and her brother wouldn't go anyways. They encountered many creatures and entities in their adventures, yet the ones who seemed like bright lights in such a foul realm would get snuffed out. Mialee kept a paper, where she marked a tick with some light magic for every person she misses to always have a connection to those she's lost. Erevan was leading them to a body of a deceased deity, he was told by some people he did a job for a while ago that it could lead to what he desired. The stranger didn't provide a name or any thing, but directions and a lead is all Erevan needed to set off on the journey. Mialee has been getting an odd feeling since they've been supposedly getting closer to this supposed corpse. Eventually they see a huge skeleton laying across the Astral Sea.

Erevan directs them closer, hope glimmering in his eyes. After hundreds of years, he'll be able to get to where his parents desired. Mialee on the other hand, stood on guard as this nagging feeling in her head persists. She knows this place, or at she has read about this in one of the stories Erevan brought back to her on his ventures with her father. When they passed by the first bone, suddenly a dim black fog blocked out their view beyond the rails of the spelljammer. Mialee looks to Erevan, who is looking out into the darkness. Mialee wonders the ship with her hand raised ready to flick out a bolt at a moments notice. When she gets to the center of the ship a cloaked figure wielding a scythe appears. That's when she realized, that bastard sent them to the old remains of Myrkul, the Lord of Death. Her skin tingles and a whispering voice mutters around her but the figure doesn't move. Mialee looks back to see if her brother is fine, to which she sees her brother nodding slowly looking off to somewhere. Damn divinity, damned Astral Plane, damned slimey bastard people. To hell with it all, it could've all just been simple. Simpler purposes, simpler desires, and simpler adventures. Or maybe it all would've been much different

if she was as good in combat as her family, if she just followed their lead, maybe she could've turned the tides and sailed with her family one again. The fog slowly closes in, and the figure makes his first move. Mialee knows she can't do anything to death, and in her final moments she doesn't want to be in such anguish. She looks at Myrkul. She dreams of how she could find a purpose if she had more time. She clutches the paper in her pocket and lets out a defeated sigh.

Next thing Mialee knows, she's getting carried far out by a Astral Deva flying at considerable speeds. When she looks back to the ship, her brother still down below reaching for what looks to be a jagged circular thing. The deva speaks, telling her she shouldn't be anywhere near such a vile place. Mialee doesn't respond for a moment, just lets herself be taken away as the Astral Sea passes beneath them. She pathetically says she doesn't want to be here either. The deva looks to her, and seems to contemplate for a moment. Understanding Mialee isn't just talking about the remains of Myrkul.

"I'll take you to the Forgotten Realms, forge forward from there. Create the change from death and ill omen to prosperity, as the Ravens did."

For another hundred years, Mialee took her words to heart. She went under the name Raven to honor the aid she received, keeping Chitri to one day bring a different honor to the name.

NICKS STORY

The Story of Igneel

And the tragedy of the Urlingscar's Downfall

Igneel, born in screaming steel and burning skies, orphaned before he could even walk. Found amidst the ashes of a battlefield, he was taken in by the chief of the proud Urlingscar clan and raised as his own son.

From the moment of his joining, he was instilled the clan's traditions of honor, loyalty, and valor, where they valued strength, discipline, and legacy above all. From the moment he could hold a blade, Igneel trained relentlessly in the ways of the sword.

He fought older trainees, ran drills until his scales cracked, and learned to wield weapons heavier than his own body. By the time he came of age, Igneel had surpassed even the clan's elite.

Through it all, he became his clans Paladin, the Flame of Urlingscar, a symbol of what dragonborn should strive to be and took great pride in it.

That pride was shattered when the Urlingscar's rival clan, the Dreadmaw struck in vengeance. Their attack reduced the Urlingscar stronghold to ruin.

Igneel fought until his body broke, but when the dust settled, the Urlingscar were gone — every elder, warrior, and child. His armor, once gleaming with the pride of his clan, was left cracked and scorched. To Igneel, survival was not victory. It was failure.

When his wounds healed, he allowed grief to twist into rage and abandoned the teachings of mercy. He hunted down those responsible, leaving no survivors (or so he thought). In doing so, he believed he had sullied the clan's memory — staining their legacy of bravery with his own merciless slaughter. The dragonborn world recoiled, seeing not justice, but desecration.

It was then that Igneel made his choice, he cast away the Urlingscar name, deeming himself unworthy to carry it. He would walk the world as Igneel, stripped of heritage, burdened only by the weight of his own actions.

Haunted by the weight of his actions, Igneel cast aside his oath and turned to the life of a mercenary, becoming a wandering blade. His armor, once a proud crest of the Urlingscar, now bore only scars and shadows. He took work wherever it was offered, caring little for his own safety. To others, he was an outcast — feared for his fury, hated for his failure.

Yet he carried on, not for redemption, but because the path forward was all that remained. His sword was no longer a shield for his people, but a tool for survival. And so Igneel walks, a mercenary cloaked in exile, fighting any battle that comes his way,

his name whispered in fear and contempt. To some, he is a weapon to be wielded; to others, a curse best avoided. But beneath the scars and shadows lies a warrior who once carried the pride of a clan now lost to ash.

Whether his path leads to redemption, ruin, or simply endless wandering, only time will decide. For now, Igneel endures — not as the Flame of Urlingscar, but as a lone blade in the dark, driven forward by the weight of memory and the silence of the fallen.

ALEX'S STORY

The Tato Family was a lovely bunch of mountain dwarves who forged the greatest of hammers and longest of swords. Idaho P. Tato was son to Russet P. Tato and Hannah P. Tato with a mountain goat named Butterball. For some unknown reason the goat understood German. Russet was an abnormally large dwarf, reaching an astounding 5 feet and 8 inches in height, with broad shoulders and firm hands he puts his finest effort into smithing his tools and raising his young boy. Hannah on the other hand was on the shorter end, barely reaching above 4 feet. She wore her ginger hair in a bun but it didn't prevent all the soot and muck from reaching it. A trait her husband saw as very endearing.

"Butterball was just a fucking dick." - Idaho P. Tato

Despite having stubborn goat as a pet, Idaho had quality time wrestling it and developed quite a bond. He wasn't too interested in the arts of smithing, he turned his sights to the beautiful landscape and the nature around him. The comforts from his family gave Idaho this internal bliss not many people possessed. Russet loved a good swig of fermented garbage and Idaho often drank along side him when his father took time away from his beloved craft. Hannah would sit by them and drink some tea instead, she believed she worked best when under no influence of anything. Another trait her husband really admired about her. When Russet returned to his work after some quality time with his son, he'd work twice as hard and achieve only slightly better results. It was quite interesting to see what was believed to be perfection be improved on.

Idaho spent his years learning how to pray and practice belief, out of pure gratitude for the life he's been fortunate to live. His parents tried to guide him towards the way of smithing, but Idaho didn't take a liking to it although he wasn't all too bad. When you

have such exquisite teachers, how can one be anything but at the very worst average at a craft. Idaho started to develop a real deep relationship with alcohol, as his most treasured memories were always revolving around his intoxication. As he grew older, it became increasingly rarer to see him fully sober at any given moment. Surprisingly it didn't hinder his ability to follow his parents teachings or his desires in improving upon his own desires. Eventually his mom thought it would best fit her son to go out into the world and perhaps discover more things and be more engaged in the life around him that he so seemingly loves. It would also get him away from the family's supply of rum. Idaho loved this idea, not realizing he would probably be very deprived of a hefty sum of alcohol in this time. He grabbed some clothes, grabbed some personal belongings he held dear, and started out the door of their humble abode. On his way out, Russel stopped him and said he had a small gift for him. A weapon he forged himself so that his son can keep himself safe in the wild outer world. Idaho took his massive hammer with a smile, thanked his parents kindly and ventured off. Down the mountain, around the waters, and through the varying towns.

His ventures humbled his rather childish and naive view of the world. Some occasions caused him to have very pessimistic views on outcomes dealing with situations that required some more difficult decision making. But in the end, if he was served alcohol he didn't much mind what happened. Idaho never lost sight of his desire, eventually becoming a cleric. From that point he knew the general path his education would take. Though he did have some crude things to say to the elves he made along the way, some generational hate passed down, but once again if they served him some rum or some of that divine elven wine, he would soften up very quickly.

QADAFFI'S STORY

She grew up in a remote elven settlement deep within the green hush of old-growth forest. The village was quiet, peaceful, and suspicious of outsiders — exactly the kind of place where a child could learn to move unseen, loose arrows with effortless grace, and vanish into the trees before a branch finished swaying. She wasn't a troublemaker, but she was curious, and curiosity, as the elders said, never travels alone. What set her apart from other young elves wasn't her skill with a bow — though she had that in abundance — but the strange, unbreakable calm within her. Even as a child, nothing rattled her. Panic never touched her voice, and fear slid off her like dew off leaves. Some called it a blessing from Corellon. Others whispered it was unnatural. She ignored both. What she did not ignore was the silver locket. It was her only inheritance from her mother, who died before she could remember her. The locket was simple, unimpressive to most eyes, but inside it was a pressed midnight-blue flower that never wilted. Her mother had called it a moonbloom — a flower said to grow only once every century under perfect moonlight. To her, it was more than a keepsake. It was her connection to a parent she never knew, and a piece of her identity she didn't fully understand. And then one night, it was stolen. The thief didn't break in. They didn't leave tracks. They didn't disturb a single thing except the small wooden box where the locket had been kept. The only proof someone had been there at all was a thin red thread snagged on the window latch — a thread not from her world. The elders dismissed it. "It's only a trinket," they said. "Let it go." She didn't. Something inside her hardened. She packed lightly, took her bow, and walked out of the village before dawn. She didn't make vows, didn't swear vengeance, didn't rage. She simply acted — calm, quiet, certain. The world was wide, full of thieves, slavers, smugglers, and collectors of rare things. Someone out there had decided her locket was valuable. And she had only one rule when value was involved: If something is worth stealing from me, it's worth stealing back. Since then, she has lived as a wanderer, scout, and thief when necessary. She keeps her loyalty close and her freedom closer. She takes jobs that put her near the rich, the powerful, the mysterious — anyone who might possess knowledge of rare magical items or forbidden trade networks. Every whisper of a traveling collector, every rumor of planar traffickers, every mention of a red-threaded cloak sends her tracking silently through the night. She never raises her voice. She never hesitates. And she never lets go of a trail once she's found it. One day, she will find the locket. And when she does, whoever stole it will learn that calm does not mean gentle

Nyrissa

OLIVER'S STORY

Back Story

My name is Gil Shorthalt. I am an elf that came from a secluded poor village. My mother and I are farmers. Making coin off of our crops. Taking care of acres of land with only two people is hard work. Thankfully our village folk are kind enough to help us out. My father Scanlan Shorthalt is my father. He never was apart of my life. I've only heard stories of him through my mother as I was still an infant, only remembering him as a blur. I am ashamed of my connection to him as I've asked about him through the village folk. Learning that he has slept with multiple people of any race and of any gender. This is what made me change my name to Gil Viveron taking my mothers last name. As a way to spite his.

Every few months when the crops are ripe and ready for harvest my mother and I would take them to the nearby town to sell them. The town would always be filled with people bustling about. A lavish market place with various products from places a yonder. But what always caught my attention was the town square. It had people playing music and dancing about. Smiling with joy and seemed like they lost all of their worries. I knew I wanted this in my life as my resentment for my father is what's been holding my happiness down. But getting an instrument is expensive and all the money we get from our crops is for food on the table and the cloths on our bodies. I knew I won't be able to get money the normal way.

This is where I took a turn in my life and decided to join the thieves guild. I learned how to steal and live in the shadows. Making money not only for me but for my family. After all the missions I've gotten from the guild I earned their trust and became one of the few taking missions directly from the Babayaga himself Kug B. Stroganoff the head master of the thieves guild. Being in the guild has been helpful and all but I know this life isn't for me. So I decided to leave when I've had enough money to keep me a float in this society and get my instrument.

I practiced day and night learning from musicians on how to master my trombone. After years of practice and the growing of my siblings I decided to become a traveling bard. Leaving my family behind to travel for the joy of others and spreading my name one village and town at a time. After many travels I came across the kingdom of Aethelguard and met a companion. Now him and I travel about.

ACT 1 - THE DELIAN TOMB

ACT 1:

INTRO - Set in the out of the way village of vallene, #OFHEROS find respite and a warm meal as they make their way to the main city to make a name for themselves as adventurers. Recently there's been an influx of goblins in this area and some of the foul creatures have begun attacking farms in the outskirts of this village. It isn't long until they find themselves mixed up in the pursuit of Goblins taking the daughter of the blacksmith into the depths of a long forgotten tomb. This is the opportunity to prove themselves and rescue someone in need.

Character introductions

GOALS - introduce Duke Ryomen, hint at the joe vessel they have gotten from the tomb, Have robots drop from the sides as they meet the duke, Tie their backstories to the plot.

OVERALL NOTES:

Raven being an astral elf is important in the plan to reach the upper planes for coccineum

What happened - Raven, Khaelen, Idaho, Raelys, and Gil have started their journey outside the small out of the way village of vallene. Duty call when the local blacksmith asks for their help saying that his daughter was taken by goblins. The adventurers now follow the trail to an old tomb where the goblins have made a base. They find Bess and Fiona and fight Grush the bugbear and a goblin shaman. While looting they find the secret chamber of the delian order. They confront the spirit of the long passed lord Delius who deems them worthy and entrust them with the blade he once used.

ACT II - Silks & Shadows

ACT II

Overall notes: After returning to Vallene, they meet Duke Ryomen but they are ambushed in the middle of an assassination attempt. They are joined by Ignael a childhood friend of . After fighting the mechanical rogues off, they find something odd about the mechanical rogues when one of them grabs a raven asking for help. The Duke will then ask them if they'd like to join him for his noble ball. After accepting, Gil makes moves on Fiona and gains her admiration for his confidence that others would see as lust. The other members visit the blacksmith to redeem some favors that he owes them, they have him appraise the strange relic that they found in the Delian Tomb. He tells them that it must be very old and some kind of device or vessel, he points out that there are two divots that seem like keys to activate the device. While they do that, Raelys and Sir Khaelen look around for merchants and stumble across a shady blackmarket dealer. Sir Kaelen is looking for new armor but Raelys is looking for hints of a lost heirloom. They make it official that they are now a party anonymously. Meeting at the tavern, Gorgug the old goblin servant picks them up and supplies them with proper clothing. They share stories of each other on the carriage ride there and arrive at the manor. They agree on a party name for the thunderous diddiers, and enjoy their time. There they meet numerous nobles and even Quinlan of Falhurst, who they met multiple times on their journey. They learn that Quinlan works with the Duke almost like a partnership. They hear multiple rumors, some unimportant but some more intriguing. Aethalgard is now dealing with a famine after one of their major farming villages were destroyed, a void of power where their head knight has left and his three commanders disappearing shortly after. As Sir Khaleen blackouts at the party, Raven spills some drinks on nobles on the dancefloor, and Ignael loses 50 Gold to Quinlan, Raelys goes off to explore the manor until a strange pink haired elf knocks him out. The Duke makes a toast for his guests until a loud bang interrupts the party. Footguards rush to investigate and the party follows as well. There, Raven inspects the broken glass window and realizes that there have been traces of illusion magic. The Duke learns that the perpetrator has stolen a locket from his safe, he asks the party if they could track it down and retrieve the locket his father gave to him. He offers a hefty sum as down payment and the party agrees, as they investigate, they find Raelys knocked out in a bathroom upstairs and frees her where they find the dress the pink haired elf was wearing. After further investigation they track her escape to the East wall where they follow her tracks. At a crossroads they decide to split up. Raelys and Khaleen keep going ahead to follow the trails while the rest of the party investigates a campsite where a family of tieflings are where they are trying to escape to Thoggarde. Raelys and Khaelen find a knocked down camp and get a time estimate of around 3-4 hours ago. The party regroups and they follow the trail to Swanford where they think she was. After asking around in the tavern and realizing that the townsfolk like her, the situation gets harder as they have to convince the tavernkeeper to tell them where she is staying. They learn her name is Faevra and she is currently resting in a room upstairs. Raven tries going about things peacefully but Ignael had another idea and knocked the door straight off. She was surprised and uncooperative at first but realized these people want to get the locket back and are willing to kill some bandits for it. So she agrees to tell them where the bandits are if they agree to kill the bandits. The party agrees and they arrive at the bandit camp. They initiate combat against 6 bandits and their leader.

Although they got ambushed by another mechanical rogue, they get out with their lives and now interrogate the bandit leader...

ACT III - A Weak Link in the Chain

ACT III

Overall Notes: The bandit leader holding on to their life is interrogated by the party. Through some intimidation and persuasion, the bandit leader tells them that the amulet they're looking for is with an infamous man named, "The Butcherer," known for his immoral and cruel experimentations on creatures using cybernetics, technology, etc. According to the leader, the butcherer wanted the transaction to be under the table so that it could not be tracked back to him. Whatever the party is after is wanted by very powerful groups and people. Before the party is able to get any more information out of the bandit, an unmanned drone spots you all and kills the leader before fleeing the scene. The party loots the bandit camp finding 2 scrolls of grease, 3 health potions, a staff of healing, bracers of archery, and glamoured studded leather. They decide to head east towards where the carrier headed according to the leader. On the path there, the party is blocked by a bunch of fallen trees where they get ambushed by two hired veterans. After killing the first two, three more mercenaries find them and engage them. After a long grueling fight between the party and mercenaries Quinlan is able to find the party and ensure their safety before ushering the party to follow him back to the dukes manor. At the Duke Ryomen's manor the party learn of the Order of the Chain, tasked with collecting and destroying the Muryland Device. Quinlan and Duke Ryomen offer them all protection and contracts to collect the parts of the device as they have all been forcibly put into the situation (bounties for their heads have been issued). Learning of the myth of the Threefold Sin will prove vital to the collection of all parts of the device. As the party settles in after a very long day, an intimate moment between Fiona and Gil was interrupted by a blue smoke emanating from Gil's trombone. D. Jeani (D. short for dah) appears between the both of them where this djinni introduces himself. Raven experiences hallucinations of gold fractal landscapes, dragon roars, and celestial machinery. The night goes by peacefully as the party recuperates.

ACT IV

- wake up in the manor
- raven heard whispers/voices at night from the god vessel (artifact they got in the first campaign)
- speaks to quinlan about it, cant give him answers rn (unneeded casualties??)
- Igneel finds a note in his room, from favera
- Gll gets chased by his D Jeanie posesed trombone
- Order of the Chains goal is to destroy the myralind device
- device can only be destroyed when all 3 pieces are assembles
- Ledger from Bandit Leader: (Jan 7th to March 19th) March 16 contract March 19 amulet and gold

-We are currently located in the Dukes Manor Outside Boar Wood (at the southern edge -Options: go east to Llandy, or research the device further -Vallene (where igneel joined the group) -Order of the Chains has 1 key for the myralind device, the other is lost beleived to be in the hands of the Butcher (the tech warlord) -Fiona (brown haired girl, Gils boo tang) Faevra (pink haired elf) -spend time in market of Llandy, fiddle and tabaxy monk (pog) join the group -Faevra found a lead of a recently abandnond house -secret trapdoor inside room, leads to a basement with magic items and machines, and a dead corpse on a table -DAMN Pog pisses on the corps and wajes it up, enter battle -zombies enter from end door -combat ends, defeated 2 zombies and greater undead -Fiddle takes igneel into his alternate dimension sex dungeon -Igneel strikes him with his greatsword and thunderous strike pushing him back -he then ran through the dimensional door and slams it shut. -FUCK FIDDLE, Igneel now has a burning hatred for him and will be agresive to him from here on out -find notes on a desk in basement about Wayfield and Aelthilguard (has a god vessel component, there), humans being turned into part warforged etc. -raven found a horn of blasting -Igneel found a Daern's Instant Fortress -Idaho found a wand of magic missles, and 1000 gold wrorth of various mettals -found notes in back room from where 2 zombies come from, unfamiliar clans logo, and list of test subjects hinting a 1 successful automaton (the first one) -hear noises from a room next to us, with a automaton locked up inside -it says "help" in a voice mixed of human and robot -points to raven about the god vessel (the vessel seems to like raven) -"you must destroy it, you are still organic, there is still time for you"

- raven moves the vessel closer to people and reacts: Automaton: cold, Igneel: Cold, Gil: Warm

-the automaton/human dies -raven calls GOAT WIZZARD letting him know what happens -gill enters the last room, it is spotlessly cared for with a cradle inside and used toddler toys -raven discovered traces of very strong healing magic or ritual to keep someone alive -inspected the machine awakening the undead, cant tell much about it besides it has some way to power or revive the automatons -Igneel inspects a frozen pig in the corner next to the machine, ITS A PIG, gil inspects it, ITS A WILD HOG, D Jeanie, usses his last wish on awakening the pig and dissapears -D Jeanies other 2 wishes were for (1: releasing Pog from the frozen stone 2: a unending beer mug for Pog) -Gil tames the Boar (Idaho names him Tatr T Ot) -move to a safe house for rest END

The Siege of Castle Rend

Castle Rend Magic Items

Sanguineous Oriflamme

This is an orcish battle standard that, when drenched in the blood of a particular enemy, grants all orcs within 60 feet bonuses against that enemy. Its stats are not detailed herein, but it burns red like a flare while slaked with blood.

Potion of Bear's Endurance. You gain 2d6 temporary hit points and have advantage on Constitution checks for 1 hour. Requires a hair from a bear. • Potion of Bull's Strength. You have advantage on Strength checks and your carrying capacity doubles for 1 hour. Requires a tail-hair from a bull. • Potion of Cat's Grace. You have advantage on Dexterity checks and do not take damage from falling up to 20 feet while you are not incapacitated for 1 hour. Requires a cat's claw. • Potion of Eagle's Splendor. You have advantage on Charisma checks for 1 hour. Requires an eagle's feather. • Potion of Fox's Cunning. You have advantage on Intelligence checks for 1 hour. Requires a fox's whisker. • Potion of Owl's Wisdom. You have advantage on Wisdom checks for 1 hour. Requires an owl's feather.

Castle Rend NPC Notes

Flash Cards – Major NPCs

1. Lord Saxton

- Role: Corrupt Regent
 - Description: Ambitious and ruthless, he seized control after the old baron's fall and rules with an iron fist.
 - Motivation: Maintain power at any cost.
 - Key Traits: Manipulative, authoritative, feared by subjects.
-

2. Sir Pelliton

- Role: Saxton's Enforcer
 - Description: Cruel knight who carries out Saxton's will, known for brutality and lack of mercy.
 - Motivation: Serve Saxton, enjoy the power and fear he inspires.
 - Key Traits: Sadistic, intimidating, loyal to Saxton.
-

3. Bonebreaker Dorokor

- Role: Orc Chieftain
 - Description: Leader of the White Tusk orcs, formidable in battle and shrewd in negotiations.
 - Motivation: Strengthen her clan's position; survive in a dangerous world.
 - Key Traits: Cunning, pragmatic, tough.
-

4. Pinna

- Role: Hedge Mage
 - Description: Beloved local spellcaster, wise and good-hearted, kidnapped by orcs.
 - Motivation: Protect Gravesford, help those in need.
 - Key Traits: Resourceful, compassionate, clever.
-

5. Edmund Bedegar

- Role: Rightful Heir

- Description: Young noble taken captive, potential future baron, idealistic but inexperienced.
- Motivation: Restore his family's honor and reclaim his birthright.
- Key Traits: Brave, honorable, eager to prove himself.

Flash Cards – Gravesford NPCs

1. Mayor Osric

- Role: Mayor, Cheesewright, Baker
 - Description: Rotund, kindly, owns stables and store. Ambitious but puts neighbors first.
 - Motivation: Grow Gravesford's reputation; cares for townsfolk.
 - Key Traits: Gregarious, generous, sometimes overreaches.
-

2. Ostler Hamm

- Role: Stablemaster
 - Description: Tall, thin, cautious about lending horses to strangers.
 - Motivation: Protect the animals and property.
 - Key Traits: Reserved, practical, loyal to Osric.
-

3. Millicent and Belle

- Role: Shopkeepers
 - Description: Sisters in their 30s. Millicent is a fussbudget, married; Belle is unmarried and shrewd.
 - Motivation: Keep the store running smoothly.
 - Key Traits: Millicent is meticulous; Belle is outgoing and good at negotiating.
-

4. Jago the Smith

- Role: Blacksmith
 - Description: Long black hair, storyteller, runs a town hangout.
 - Motivation: Provide for the town and enjoy socializing.
 - Key Traits: Amiable, skilled, loves a good tale.
-

5. Morgouse the Carpenter

- Role: Carpenter (formerly Weaver)
 - Description: Industrious, soft-spoken, took over husband's business, repairs town structures.
 - Motivation: Maintain and improve the village.
 - Key Traits: Diligent, practical, humble.
-

6. Giselle & Gowan (and Brecca)

- Role: Innkeepers, The Reluctant Pig
 - Description: Giselle runs the inn/bar and is tough but wary of Sir Pelliton; Gowan cooks; Brecca (13) serves and learns weaving.
 - Motivation: Run a safe and welcoming inn; protect family.
 - Key Traits: Giselle is strong-willed; Gowan is caring; Brecca is eager and friendly.
-

7. Father Belderone

- Role: Priest of St. Gaed
 - Description: Elderly, city-born, frail but wise, offers blessings for donations to repair the church.
 - Motivation: Care for villagers' spiritual and real needs.
 - Key Traits: Compassionate, practical, values truth.
-

8. Carroc

- Role: Wealthy Farmer
 - Description: Owns the largest farm, arrogant, pious, aspires to nobility, dislikes adventurers.
 - Motivation: Gain status, gain favor with Sir Pelliton.
 - Key Traits: Proud, stubborn, well-off.
-

9. Helanna

- Role: Elderly Farmer
- Description: Sun-baked, calloused grandmother, beloved by townsfolk, loves adventure stories.
- Motivation: Support the community, enjoy tales of heroism.
- Key Traits: Friendly, wise, encouraging.

10. Ryon & Lenore

- Role: Bridge Guards
- Description: Ryon (man), Lenore (woman), lightly trained, watch the bridge at town's edge.
- Motivation: Keep Gravesford safe from forest threats.
- Key Traits: Dutiful, untested, cautious.

11. Alyssa Tealeaf

- Role: Halfling Scout, Friend of Pinna
- Description: Outgoing, resourceful, adventurous, loyal friend.
- Motivation: Rescue Pinna, help friends in need.
- Key Traits: Brave, capable, determined.

ACT V

Preparation Six Days

The party prepared for war.

In the castle's depths, they discovered a hidden vault filled with gold and platinum, funding their defenses.

They fortified the castle and gathered allies:

Idaho & Gil traveled to Llandy:

Called in favor with the Thieves' Guild

Met Volkan and Zanwin, who were searching for Pog

Raelys & Raven returned to Boar Wood:

Sought aid from druids to protect the forest and the castle

The Siege Begins

On the sixth day:

Reinforcements arrived from Quinlan

Allies Zya and Girr joined the defense

Then

Trumpets sounded.

And suddenly...

Sir Pelliton appeared inside the castle, teleporting in with a Mage and Wizard, bypassing all defenses.

The Final Battle

Pelliton was different.

Stronger.

Empowered.

His strength appeared linked to the Mage supporting him.

Then, he unleashed something beyond normal magic:

A Domain Expansion

The party was pulled into a pocket dimension, a battlefield where Pelliton held every advantage.

The fight turned desperate.

Ignael's Awakening

At the brink of defeat...

Ignael changed.

A power within him surged something ancient, radiant, and unknown.

His strike deeply wounded Pelliton
Wings of pure energy manifested behind him
He rose into the air

And with a final, devastating blow

He brought his blade down in radiant fury.

Pelliton was obliterated.

The domain collapsed.

ACT VI

Return from the Domain

As Sir Pelliton falls, the pocket dimension collapses.

Reality snaps back.

The party is **returned to Castle Rend**.

- **Pelliton lies barely alive**
- His **Mage ally stands defeated**, hands raised—but still dangerous
- The remaining enemies have **fled the battlefield**

The fight is over.

But the tension isn't.

The Mage's Gambit

Raven raises a **fireball**, holding it behind her head—ready to kill.

She demands the Mage drop her spell.

The Mage doesn't comply.

Instead, she **laughs**... steps forward... and **places Raven's own hand against her head**.

"Do it."

Gil attempts *Hold Person*—it fails.

The Mage snaps her fingers, resisting control.

Ignael steps beside Raven, blade drawn, silent but threatening.

Gil pulls a dagger on the unconscious Pelliton.

The Mage doesn't care.

"He's just a tool."

She looks at the party—curious.

"I want to see what you're made of."

Raven gives her one chance:

“Leave.”

The Mage smirks...

...and vanishes into **black smoke**.



The Humbling of Sir Pelliton

With the Mage gone, the party turns to Pelliton.

- **Gil removes his armor**—barely avoiding a lash of dark energy from it
- Pelliton is stripped, restrained, and tied to a chair
- **Idaho heals him slightly**
- He is awakened... forcibly

Pelliton, still arrogant:

“I can’t believe I lost to you... I’d rather be spat on again.”

What follows is less interrogation... and more **humiliation mixed with intimidation**.

Despite everything, Pelliton breaks.



Interrogation Results

Under pressure, Pelliton reveals:

- He serves **Lord Saxson**, ruler of the northern lands (**Wafeld region**)
- He is one of the “**Three Roses**”
 - The others:
 - **Lady Ruth**
 - **Sir Anglin**
- He acts out of:
 - Power
 - Fear
 - Control over the weak

When asked why he terrorized Gravesford:

“Because they’re weak. And I can.”

He confirms:

- The other knights **will come**
- The party has made powerful enemies

When asked where to find Saxson:

“Wafeld... good luck finding him.”

Judgment

The party debates his fate:

- **Raven** questions him further
- **Khaelen** pushes the idea of redemption
- **Ignael rejects it outright**, stating:

“Men like him don’t change.”

Ultimately:

 Pelliton is **imprisoned in the castle basement**

- Guarded by:
 - **Chester (the mimic)**
 - **007 James (Gil’s minion)**

The threat is contained.

For now.

The Armor of Darkness

Pelliton’s armor is examined.

- It emits the same **black tendril energy** seen earlier

- **Idaho confirms its magical nature**

Then—

Khaelen puts it on.

 (Hidden Truth — DM Knowledge)

The armor belongs to **Panzuriel**

It grants power...

At the risk of consuming Khaelen entirely.

 New Power — Raven

Raven studies a scroll recovered from the fallen wizard.

After careful work:

 She learns **Teleportation Circle**

A major leap in mobility and strategy.

 Quinlan Contact

Using a calling stone, the party contacts **Quinlan**.

- Initial silence... then response
- He confirms:
 - They already have sufficient funding
- Requests to speak privately with **Gil later**

Tension remains between allies.

 Fractures Within the Party

- **Ignael isolates himself**, overwhelmed by his awakening power
- He feels something in his blood... something growing
- That night:
 - He dreams of a **dragon's roar**

Meanwhile:

- **Raven begins hearing voices again**
 - She engages with it

(Hidden Truth — DM Knowledge)

This is **Primus**, guiding her toward assembling the **Muryland Device**
Promising to **restore her family... as modrons**

New Problems

- **Zanwyn, Volkan, and Pog have disappeared**
- **Faevra is actively searching for them**
- **Zya and Girr remain with the party**

This creates immediate urgency.

Decision Point

The party discusses their next move:

Options:

1. **Track Zanwyn & Volkan (Thieves Guild / Rogue Arc)**  *Chosen*
2. Explore Ignael's power
3. Follow Raven's visions
4. Continue main quest (Butcherer / Order)

They choose:

 **The Rogue Path — Find Zanwyn, Volkan, and Pog**

Journey to Wafeld (Preparation Phase)

After a long rest, the party departs.

Market Events:

- **Gil trades items** → gets magical earrings
- Earrings revealed as **Earrings of Alter Self**
- **Raven buys:**
 - Stone of Returning
 - “All-or-Nothing” Coin (crit success / crit fail)
- Shopkeeper demonstrates magic... chaos ensues

Incident:

- Raven manipulates the shopkeeper's mind
 - He escalates → arms himself with magical gear
 - Brief combat breaks out (Raven, Gil, Idaho)
 - He **escapes**
-



Ignael's Deal

Ignael encounters a **mysterious goblin trader**

Offered:

- Radiant blade
- Skull mace
- Fine greatsword

He trades his weapon and moves on.



The Thieves Guild Entrance

The party arrives at a **church in Wafeld**

- A mass is in progress
- They wait

Afterward:

- Priest gives no answers
- Suggests checking behind the church

There—

They see **Zanwyn jump into a well**

The party follows.

They fall—

And are caught.



Trapped in a Net

After The Well - Qad,Oli, Alex

“As the party jumps down the well, you’re all met with the cool moist air of the walls as you freefall. As you all fall, the well widens up and you’re all caught in a net. Struggling seems to be useless and the room lights up from the torches. A slow clap echoes through the chamber. Bootsteps follow. From a wooden platform above, a hooded figure leans over the edge of the railing, lantern light revealing a familiar grin.

Zanwyn.

‘Well...’ he says, looking over the tangled party.

‘That couldn’t have been easier.’

A few scattered chuckles come from the shadows around the room. As your eyes adjust, you begin noticing them:

People. Not guards. Not soldiers. Observers. Men and women perched along walkways and staircases carved into the stone walls of the underground chamber. Some cleaning daggers. Some gambling. Some simply watching the six of you with open curiosity. One voice calls out from somewhere in the dark:

‘Told you the loud one would jump first.’

Another:

‘Nah, I had gold on the dragon.’

A coin pouch exchanges hands and the smell of smoke, ale, and damp stone fills the air. Then - A few figures move in close to the net with practiced efficiency. Before anyone can properly react, rough hands grab at you all. Cloth is pressed over your mouths and noses. A sharp chemical smell. You start to lose feeling in your fingertips before your limbs get heavy. Then darkness. Gil, Idaho, and Raelys slowly regain consciousness. Your heads pound and wrists ache. You’re seated beside one another in heavy wooden chairs bolted to the stone floor, iron cuffs binding your hands behind your back. A single lantern above you all swings slowly. You can hear a maddening dripping noise elsewhere in the dark. All your gear has been separated but is sitting nearby, neatly organized. Nothing is missing.

“Good. You’re awake.”

The lantern swings again, briefly revealing him as he steps into view just beyond the edge of light. He doesn’t rush. Doesn’t threaten. Just watches the three of you for a long moment, like he’s assessing a completed calculation. Then, quietly:

“Let’s make this simple.”

“We want you guys to help us take down saxton”

THE SIGNET

The Rose Signet

A black-gold signet ring bearing:

- a rose wrapped around a sword
- or three intertwined roses
- engraved with subtle runic script

Recognized by:

- guards
- officers
- nobility
- informants

Not magical in a flashy way.

Powerful because of what it REPRESENTS.

OPTION 1 — Lord Saxson Himself

BEST for intimidation + politics

The signet never leaves his hand.

Meaning:

the party must get close to HIM.

This creates:

- conversation scenes
- tension
- social infiltration
- proximity to danger

Saxson should feel terrifyingly composed.

The kind of man who notices details instantly.

Possible moment:

Raelys or Gil bumps into him during the dance.

Saxson calmly catches their wrist.

Smiles.

“Careful.”

Then lets go.

That alone builds tension.

OPTION 2 — Lady Ruth

BEST for manipulation/social intrigue

One of the Three Roses.

Elegant.

Dangerous.

Politically brilliant.

She wears the signet openly because:

nobody would dare steal from her.

This creates AMAZING social scenes.

She could:

- flirt for information
- test the party verbally
- subtly threaten them
- recognize Khaelen’s noble behavior
- see through Gil immediately

And if SHE notices the theft attempt:
the rooftop chase becomes personal.

OPTION 3 — Sir Anglin

BEST for intimidation/action

A veteran Rose Knight.

Huge presence.

Military aura.

Keeps the signet attached to his armor or gauntlet.

Harder to steal physically.

This version turns the ballroom into:

“how do we get near this monster?”

Could involve:

- distraction
- staged accident
- fake emergency

After The Well - Kub, Nick, Yug

“As the party jumps down the well, you’re all met with the cool moist air of the walls as you freefall. As you all fall, the well widens up and you’re all caught in a net. Struggling seems to be useless and the room lights up from the torches. A slow clap echoes through the chamber. Bootsteps follow. From a wooden platform above, a hooded figure leans over the edge of the railing, lantern light revealing a familiar grin.

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‘Nah, I had gold on the dragonborne.’

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The room begins to spin.

Raven catches the faint sound of laughter.

Ignael feels his limbs grow heavy.

Khaelen hears the distant whisper of metal grinding against metal from somewhere deep inside his armor.

Then—

Darkness.

The three of you slowly awaken.

Your heads pound.

Your wrists ache.

You're seated in separate wooden chairs around a circular stone table, hands restrained in iron cuffs connected by chains bolted to the floor.

A single lantern swings overhead.

Drip. Drip. Drip.

Water echoes somewhere nearby.

Unlike before, this room is quiet.

No laughter.

No crowd.

Just the three of you.

And standing near the doorway—

Zanwyn.

He flips a dagger in his hand absentmindedly before speaking.

He pulls out a chair and sits backwards in it, arms folded over the backrest.

Possible Dialogues

'Relax.'

'If we wanted you dead, you'd still be unconscious.'

'You three are different for what we need you all to do.'

'Which is exactly why I wanted to talk to you separately.'

'You're deniable agents'

"Saxson's grip on Wafeld isn't just politics."

"It's fear."

"Supplies."

"Blackmail."

“And whatever the hell he’s moving through Fort Blackreach.” He tosses a rolled map onto the table.

IF ASKED WHAT FORT BLACKREACH IS SAY

Small Fortress. Just a little west off the skirts of Wafeld. Officially? Supply Depot. Unofficially? Nobody who gets sent there ever comes back. Rumors about cursed weapons being forged, augmentation experiments, and more than enough soldiers to make this difficult for just any mercenary group that we could find. That’s where you three come in.

TO BE VERY CLEAR

We don’t want you to scout, we could do that. We want you to retrieve names, shipment routes, prison transfers, and supporters of Saxton, and if you can hinder Saxton in any way possible.

IF ASKED “why not do it yourself”

Because if the Thieves Guild attacks Blackreach, we’re effectively declaring war on saxton.

But you all?

You’re already wanted criminals.

If they ask about Pog just say simply: He followed us when we left, we didn’t want to stay too long so he followed us. It's that simple.

THE AUGMENTED KNIGHT

Visual Design

He steps out slowly.

Not rushed. Not feral.

Controlled.

- heavy black iron plating (incomplete fusion)
- visible seams where metal meets flesh
- glowing runic veins under skin

- one arm fully mechanical, the other still human
- helm slightly cracked → you can see one calm eye

He is not shouting.

He is breathing like a soldier at parade rest.

Guest List

5/31/26

Reputation with thieves guild +2
Reputation with lord Saxton -2

Gil

Raven

Ignael - IF IGNAEL TRIES ATTUNING TO THE BLACK IRON GREATSWORD:

As the others settle in for the evening, Ignael takes a moment for himself with the Black Iron blade sitting in his lap. The metal seems too dark. As if it drinks in the firelight instead of reflecting it. As Ignael places his hand upon the hilt and focuses on forming the bond, the familiar warmth in his blood begins to stir— a faint pulse. The sword hums. Not loudly. Just enough for him to feel it through his fingers. A pulse. And another. Like a heartbeat. The warmth in your chest spreads down your arm and into the weapon. For a moment, you feel resistance. Like two rivers flowing against one another. The warmth presses onward. The humming grows sharper. Then— Silence. The resistance breaks. The sword goes still. You look down. For the briefest moment, the dark shine running through the metal flashes gold. Not bright. Not enough for anyone else to notice. Just a single flicker. Then it vanishes. Yet something feels different. The weapon feels lighter in your hands.

Kaelen

Raelys

Idaho: THE BLACKSMITH WILL RECOGNIZE THE CRAFTMANSHIP OF IDAHO'S HAMMER AND CALL HIM OVER ASKING HIM WHERE HE GOT SUCH A RARE PIECE (party will learn he comes from a family of extraordinarily gifted blacksmiths)

"We return to the party reunited sharing their stories and the information that they have learnt"

Interrogation of The Blackreach Captain:

She's loyal to Wafeld but not devoted to Saxton

She's willing to give information if she's convinced that she's safe if she agrees to help (DC Persuasion 15)

ONLY ANSWERS WHAT SHE'S QUESTIONED

Fort Blackreach

- Officially a supply depot.
- Secretly a proving ground.
- Successful experiments are sent elsewhere.

The Hollow Forge

- Real.
- Location unknown.
- Personnel and experiments are regularly transferred there.

The Butcherer

- Visits occasionally.
- Never stays long.
- Most soldiers fear him.

Lord Saxson

- Rarely appears personally.
- Operates through messengers and trusted retainers.
- His inner circle is difficult to reach.

Guest Records

She recognizes some names on the guest list.

Several nobles and merchants are secretly funding Blackreach.

Information Reveal

The biggest piece of information:

Operation Iron Vein

A massive shipment is scheduled tonight. (No time for a long rest but theres time for a short)

Weapons.

Armor.

Black Iron components.

Research materials.

Everything is heading toward:

Wafeld City

This gives the thieves guild their first real opportunity.

Scene 2: Guild Strategy Meeting

After the interrogation, Zanwyn gathers everyone.

Maps cover the table.

Names from Blackreach are pinned to boards.

Routes are marked in charcoal.

For the first time:

The thieves guild starts treating the party like partners.

Zanwyn's Assessment

"We finally have proof."

"The problem is proof doesn't kill lords."

The guild identifies three possible paths.

Option 1: Lay Low

The safest route.

Benefits:

Heat dies down.

Injuries recover.

Research can be analyzed.

New contacts arrive.

This lets players pursue personal RP.

Option 2: Follow The Shipment

The guild wants to locate Operation Iron Vein.

Could reveal:

Hollow Forge location

Butcherer activity

Saxson's military plans

More dangerous.

More immediate.

Zanwyn's Proposal

"Forget Saxson."

"Find where he's sending this."

Because:

If they find the destination...

They find the Hollow Forge.

Session 1: Ambush the Convoy

The party tracks the shipment.

Could:

sneak aboard

steal documents

attack escorts

They discover:

The convoy is much larger than expected.

Option 3: Build Support

Use the evidence politically.

Gather:

nobles

merchants

townsfolk

rival factions

The party begins creating a coalition against Saxson.

Slower.

Potentially huge payoff.

"Saxson doesn't rule because he's loved."

"He rules because everyone thinks he's inevitable."

Faction 1: The Merchants

Saxson's tariffs and seizures are hurting trade.

Potential Ally: A merchant consortium.

Need: Evidence of corruption.

Reward: Money. Supplies. Information network.

Faction 2: The Displaced Nobles

Families whose land was taken.

Potential Ally: A noble house hiding in Wafeld.

Need: Protection or leverage.

Reward: Political legitimacy.

Faction 3: The Common Folk

Villages hate Saxson's taxes.

Need: A symbol.

The party becomes that symbol.

Reward: Scouts. Shelter. Local support.

Faction 4: The Military

The hardest.

Some officers dislike Saxson.

Need: Proof of Blackreach.

Reward: Actual soldiers.

They can do this at the marketplace, Carnival, barracks.

Scene 3: Marketplace and The Carnival

Complication System

I would secretly track:

Heat Level

Starts at 0.

Every suspicious action raises it.

Examples:

+1

drawing weapons

public spellcasting

+2

fighting

threatening people

+3

causing a scene

At certain thresholds:

Heat 3

A bounty hunter notices them.

Heat 5

City guards begin actively searching.

Heat 8

Someone reports their location to Saxson.

Marketplace:

"Blacksmith": *Durgan Ironhand* is a dwarf who yells out his wares to the masses. He is paranoid about pickpockets, which explains why his most valuable wares are securely chained to his anvil. (REFER TO THE TOP FOR HIS INTERACTION WITH IDAHO)

The "Herbalist": Eiseth is a tiefling who mutters while she sells strange concoctions. She doesn't take coin, but instead demands an interesting secret or a bizarre local favor for her rarest potions.

The "Mapmaker": Fiddlewick is an animated gnome who draws "living" maps that constantly update themselves. He is overly eager to barter for any new, undocumented dungeon locations the party has discovered.

A random encounter 1d4

The Rival Party: The heroes run into a rival group of adventurers who are also shopping. They might try to outbid the party for a rare magic item, or attempt to steal the players' hard-earned quest rewards right out of their hands.

The Monster on the Loose: A merchant's exotic, caged beast (e.g., an Otyugh or a Displacer Beast) breaks loose, and the party is tasked with subduing the creature without destroying the market stalls

A pickpocket:

CARNIVAL:

Random encounters -

Fortune Teller

Can hint at future arcs.

For Raven:

"I see a future of ordered chaos."

For Khaelen:

"The only one who can destroy the man they are is the man himself."

For Ignael:

"Power is within your reach, are you willing to hold on."

For everyone else roll a d10

PROPHECIES OF THE WANDERING ORACLE

When subtle omens stir, fading flames, shifting stones, deepening shadows, fate awakens. Roll a d10 to see which prophecy answers the call.

d10 Description & Effect

- 1 Legends claim that waters swift enough to blur their own reflection can loosen time's steady march. Those who touch such currents may grasp a single moment and twist its thread.

Trigger:

The character submerges their entire hand in fast-moving natural water (a rapid river or mountain stream).

Effect - One Use:

After seeing the result of any d20 roll (attack, save, or ability check), the character may reroll that d20 and choose which result to keep.

- 2 Those who greet the rising sun with water upon their brow receive the day's first clarity.

Trigger:

The character washes their face with clean water at dawn.

Effect - One Use:

The character gains +2 to the first Wisdom ability check they make that day.

- 3 When night accepts your first flame, it reveals paths unseen by even the keenest eyes.

Trigger:

The character lights a fire after sunset.

Effect - One Use:

The character may cast guidance once without requiring concentration.

- 4 Open hands placed upon a living trunk invite the forest's ancient memory to guide one's steps.

Trigger:

The character places both hands on a healthy living tree.

Effect - One Use:

The character has advantage on the first Survival check made in the next 24 hours.

- 5 To step into pure darkness without one's own flame is to borrow sight from the night and every debt must be repaid.

Trigger:

The character enters complete darkness while carrying no source of light.

Effect - One Use:

The character has disadvantage on their next Perception check based on hearing or touch.



PROPHECIES OF THE WANDERING ORACLE

When subtle omens stir, fading flames, shifting stones, deepening shadows, fate awakens. Roll a d10 to see which prophecy answers the call.

d10 Description & Effect

6 A spit cast upon the earth awakens a chill buried deeper than root or stone.

Trigger:

The character spits onto natural ground.

Effect - One Use:

The character immediately takes 1 cold damage.

7 A blade turned inward calls misfortune like a hungry spirit.

Trigger:

The character injures themselves with their own blade or tool.

Effect - One Use:

The character has disadvantage on their next attack roll.

8 A harsh word thrown at the innocent returns with doubled weight.

Trigger:

The character insults someone who responds without anger or hostility.

Effect - One Use:

The character suffers -2 to their next Charisma ability check.

9 A stone shifting under an unhurried step hints at paths best left unwalked.

Trigger:

The character steps on a loose or uneven stone that shifts under their weight.

Effect - One Use:

The character gains +1d4 to their next Dexterity saving throw.

10 A flame dimming at your approach hints at a moment of failing resolve.

Trigger:

A candle, torch, or campfire dims slightly as the character comes near.

Effect - One Use:

The character takes -2 on their next attack roll.

End of Session Hook

As the night winds down, Zanwyn finds the party.

He places a sealed document on the table.

"We've finished reading the Blackreach records."

He looks at the group.

"I think we just found our way to Saxson."

Then reveal:

06/02/26

I NEED TO RAIL
RING

Opening Scene: A Lead at the Blood & Ale

The party is gathered in one of the guild's hidden rooms when the door opens.

Zanwyn steps inside.

Unlike his usual smug self, he looks tired.

He's carrying several folded maps and loose papers.

Without a word he tosses them onto the table.

Most are crossed out.

Dead leads.

False sightings.

Rumors.

Nothing useful.

He finally drops into a chair.

"Good news."

"I finally found someone useful."

Pause.

"Bad news."

"He knows he's useful."

A small grin.

If they ask if he's trustworthy

Zanwyn shrugs.

"Absolutely not."

Pause.

"But he's usually honest when somebody's paying him."

If they ask what he knows

Zanwyn slides a folded note across the table.

The handwriting is sloppy.

Only three words:

"Blood & Ale. Tonight."

Zanwyn's Briefing

"He claims he has information about Saxson's supply network."

"Maybe Blackreach."

"Maybe the Hollow Forge."

"Maybe something bigger."

What Zanwyn Actually Knows

He can provide:

- The informant uses the alias **Crow**.
- Nobody knows his real name.
- He deals in secrets.
- He's survived far longer than most informants.

Which usually means he's either:

- very smart
- very dangerous
- or both

"One more thing."

He points directly at the group.

"Don't mention Blackreach first."

If asked why:

"Because if that's what he wants to talk about..."

"He'll bring it up."

"If he doesn't..."

"Then somebody's testing you."

Blood & Ale Tavern

When they arrive:

Outside you all look up where the sign is etched with a slogan:

"Leave your grudges at the door. Pick them back up when you leave."

The tavern is packed.

The Blood & Ale isn't merely a tavern.

It's a neutral ground.

A place where mercenaries, thieves, adventurers, bounty hunters, information brokers, merchants, and the occasional noble can coexist without immediately trying to kill each other.

Most of the time.

Weapons Check

Immediately inside the entrance sits a reinforced counter.

Three heavily armed attendants stand behind it.

No uniforms.

Just people who clearly know how to hurt someone.

Every patron is expected to surrender obvious weapons.

Each item receives a numbered brass token.

Things Allowed

- Small utility knives
- Holy symbols
- Arcane focuses

Things Not Allowed

- Greatswords
- Polearms
- Battleaxes
- Explosives
- Horns of Blasting (hopefully)

The rooms is filled with music. Drinking. Dice games. Arguments. Nothing unusual. No obvious informant.

The Brawler Pit

At the center of the room is a circular sand pit.

Twenty feet across.

Wooden railings surround it.

People gather around cheering.

Fighting is constant.

Rules are simple:

1. No weapons.
2. No killing.

3. The house gets a cut of wagers.

Currently:

A dwarf is beating a half-orc with a chair.

The crowd is loving it.

Pinna

Near the far wall sits a familiar face.

Pinna

The self-taught wizard.

She is surrounded by books.

Several sheets of parchment.

A half-finished meal.

And three empty mugs.

Upon seeing the party:

"Oh thank the gods."

She immediately closes a notebook.

"Do you know how boring castle duty is?"

She has reports.

Nothing critical.

But she has been investigating some names from Blackreach.

Nyx

The party may notice her only if they actively observe the room.

Gone is the noble disguise.

Gone is the expensive clothing.

Gone is the carefully crafted persona.

Instead:

A woman in practical traveling clothes.

Dark cloak.

Boots.

Hair tied back.

Sitting alone.

Watching.

Listening.

She does not approach them.

She does not reveal herself.

But if they recognize her:

She smiles.

Almost impressed.

As though she's curious what they'll do.

Then let the players investigate.

The fun part is figuring out:

Who is Crow?

Possible options:

Option 1: The Bartender

"Old Garrick"

A massive bald man.

Broad shoulders.

Scar across one eye.

Polishes the same mug repeatedly.

First Impression

Gruff.

Unfriendly.

Looks like he could throw Khaelen through a wall.

Reality

He knows everything.

Absolutely everything.

People talk to bartenders.

They always have.

If questioned carefully:

He knows:

- who entered recently
- who left recently
- who is lying
- who is dangerous

Sample Dialogue

"Information costs money."

"Good information costs more money."

"Crow?"

"Never heard of him."

Insight Check DC 10:

He's lying.

Terribly.

If bribed:

"The person you're looking for isn't hiding."

"You're just looking in the wrong place."

Option 2: The Drunk

The Drunkard

"Bren"

At first glance:

Completely wasted.

Slumped in a corner.

Ale running down his beard.

Mumbling nonsense.

Reality:

He's an informant.

A very good one.

Clue

Every time someone enters:

His eyes open.

Just briefly.

Then close again.

If Approached

"You got any potatoes?"

No matter what they ask.

If given potatoes:

"Now we're conducting business."

What He Actually Knows

Everything occurring in the streets.

Nothing occurring behind closed doors.

He can provide:

- gang activity

- bounty hunter sightings
 - suspicious shipments
 - guard movements
-

Option 3: The Musician

"Elias Thorn"

Human.

Late thirties.

Playing a lute near the fireplace.

At first:

Just another musician.

But observant players notice:

He never misses anything.

Never.

Every conversation.

Every argument.

Every entrance.

Every exit.

He notices all of it.

Secret

Elias is a Harper Agent.

Working deep undercover.

He's been investigating Saxson for years.

If Approached

He's polite.

Charming.

Careful.

"Requests cost copper."

"Answers cost trust."

What He Knows

Potentially more than Zanwyn.

But he reveals information slowly.

He knows:

- Blackreach existed
 - The Butcherer exists
 - Several missing persons cases
 - Noble corruption
-

He suspects:

The Hollow Forge is real.

Harper Test

Before helping:

He asks a simple question.

"If overthrowing a tyrant required breaking the law..."

"Would you do it?"

He isn't trying to find Crow.

He's trying to figure out why Crow is interested in them.

If they reveal too much:

He becomes concerned.

If they mention Blackreach:

He becomes *very* concerned.

There is no correct answer.

He's judging character.

Option 4: The Waitress

"Mira"

Young.

Sharp-eyed.

Constantly moving.

Never stops working.

She carries drinks.

Food.

Messages.

Secrets.

She seems ordinary.

She isn't.

She works for three different groups simultaneously.

The Tavern

Her actual job.

The Thieves Guild

Passing information.

Herself

Most importantly.

What She Notices

Everything.

Who tips.

Who lies.

Who flirts.

Who fights.

Who's nervous.

Who doesn't belong.

If The Party Talks To Her

At first:

"Order something."

Then:

"Okay now what do you actually want?"

She can provide:

- rumors
- names
- recent arrivals
- suspicious guests

Special Detail

She knows exactly who Crow is.

She just won't tell them.

Instead:

She smiles.

Points somewhere else.

And says:

"Warmer."

The Twist

When they finally identify Crow:

He isn't interested in introductions.

He already knows exactly who they are.

He sits down.

Takes a drink.

Then says:

"So."

"You lot are the reason Lord Saxson abandoned Fort Blackreach."

Long pause.

"That caused quite a bit of trouble."

BOUNTIES -

808 GOLD KUBA

1337 GOLD QADAFFI

706 GOLD ALEX

936 GOLD OLI

990 GOLD YUG

1241 GOLD NICK

06/08/26

Widow's Ring
Yug's Armor?
Rework Map
Settlement (castle)

Recap:

Blackreach is abandoned
Hollow Forge is beneath the castle
The thieves guild has fled
A shipment arrives tonight
Raven got a mysterious note
The thieves guild left in a hurry
The dog is the only one left

Burned. Secondary Locations. Do Not Return

"The first thing you hear is rain. A steady drizzle against a window, and one by one you all wake. It's awfully calm then events of yesterday return. The shipment is tonight and the thieves guild are unknown. As you gather downstairs for breakfast, you all notice something odd. The dog is awake possibly hungry, but everytime someone walks past the inn, his ears perk up. He's looking, waiting, for someone..."

What are your characters doing.

In the common room, once you find a seat you notice the Copper Kettle is mostly empty. A few travelers sit near the fireplace near the wall and a merchant quietly counting his coin at a table by himself. Behind the counter is an elderly woman who seems to be the inn keeper.

Before you can call the lady, she comes back out from behind the kitchen. She wears her worn out apron stained with different ingredients. Her hands rough from working the inn. Without asking, she begins setting food down on your table, bread, eggs, stew. enough food to feed all of you. "Anything else you all want?" She then shakes her head, "Whatever you lot are mixed up in... ooooh you've got the look." She gestures towards the pile of food. "Eat. Plan. Argue. Do whatever adventurers do before running off to make my day more difficult." She starts walking away before stopping. "And if you're planning something stupid... atleast finish breakfast."

What would you all like to do?

THINGS YOU CAN DO BEFORE THEY LEAVE THE INN TO PUSH THEM IN A DIRECTION:
BOUNTY HUNTERS - From outside you hear shouting. The dog immediately perks up. Someone is yelling, boots splashing in the puddles. The innkeeper whispers under her breath, "Guards." then looks down. The footsteps past the front door, "MOVE! YOu're coming with us."

you hear a protest, then a crash. If the party investigates, they will overhear a guard saying, "Double the patrols, saxon's orders. Nobody gets near the castle tonight"

THE DOG - The party hears the dog barking, a beggar outside. Once the party arrives, the person leaves a package. Inside there are lockpicks, disguises (military), military insignias, forged permits (merchants), and route sketches. The only thing attached is a note written with "You'll need these" along with a crow feather.

"As you all finish eating, one of the adventurers have decided to leave and as he open the door, the dog bolts out."

Chase Segment 1: The rain has settled into a cool drizzle. The streets are busy with Workers. Merchants. Travelers. And Guards. The dog is now half a block ahead.
3 successes before 2 failures

Perception

- Spot the dog weaving through crowds.

Athletics

- Push through pedestrians.

Acrobatics

- Vault carts or obstacles.

Survival

- Track muddy pawprints.

Investigation

- Follow disturbances left behind.

Stealth

A crowd of guards is surely to spot you all. Hide from being spotted.

Success Example

As you round a corner, you spot the dog standing atop a fruit crate.

He scans the crowd.

The moment he sees you, he barks once and continues running.

Failure Example

A wagon blocks your path.

By the time you get around it, you've lost sight of him.

Fortunately, a nearby vendor points further down the street.

"Dog ran that way."

After nearly giving up, you hear barking somewhere in the distance.

Chase Segment 2: The Northern Industrial Quarter

Eventually the city changes. Very different from what you all have seen ever since you gotten to the city. The crowds are nowhere to be seen. The buildings have become older, neglected, and abandoned. Broken smokestacks, rust stains run down stone walls. Whatever industry once thrived has long since died. The dog finally slows to a stop and is now panting.

Clue #1

The party notices something.

A small scrap of cloth caught on a nail.

It belongs to a military cloak.

Same color as the one Corvin wore.

This confirms they're following the right trail.

Clue #2

Further ahead:

A hidden symbol scratched into brick.

Anyone familiar with military markings recognizes it.

It's a directional marker.

A breadcrumb.

Someone wanted to find this place again.

The dog sprints toward the warehouse. For the first time all morning, he stops running. He scratches at the big wooden double door. His tail is wagging furiously, and then he looks back at you all.

Roll perception check

5 - Someone has been here

10 - Fresh Boor prints

15 - multiple set of prints, some entering and some leaving, but one set much heavier than normal.

20 - One set of foot prints has very unusual spacing and depth. Whoever made it must be significantly stronger than a normal person.

The door creaks loudly open. The smell of oil, old iron, and rain soaked wood hit your senses. The interior is mostly filled with broken machinery yet among the ruins are signs of life. A bedroll, a lantern, a used cooking pot. Someone lives here, and judging by the warmth in the room they might not be gone for long. (If they failed to track the dog fast enough they only have time to investigate items twice before Corvin arrives.)

An old military chest sits next to a bedroll: Lockpicking DC 10

Contents - Rusted war medals, army insignia, a folded family sketch, and several unopened letters. Opening one reads: (give handout)

Crate of medicine: A crate sits to the side of the bedroll. It contains vials. Most empty. A few remain.

Medicine Check 10 - They're suppressants meant to prevent symptoms

A label says: Property of Hollow Forge Recovery Division

Journal: Sits on the table with a few gold pouches sitting around

Shipment Maps: rolled out on a crate.

Corvin Arrives:

The wooden door creaks open, followed by a "Who's there?". Standing in the doorway is Corvin, rain still dripping from his cloak, hand on his sword. He sees the dog, then you guys, then his open belongings.

"You read it..."

Not angry but tired.

DIALOGUE MAIN POINTS:

"I can't go home, I'm afraid. Afraid I'll hurt them. Without my suppressants keeping me stable, I blackout, and my memory gets foggy, then... my conditioning"

"They were compromised. Someone was leaking information, Zanwyn ordered for a complete evacuation with no traces, I separated before anything went south. I left the dog just in case you all came back, hoping he'd lead you all back to me. Thank you for taking care of him, although he can handle himself"

"What did they do to you?"

He responds, "well you know I volunteered, but I was just a soldier. A wall collapsed on me during a siege. I was crushed all on my left side, said I'd never fight again."

He laughs bitterly,

"Then I was given an offer for the recovery program. Said it would fix damaged soldiers. Give back the lives we fought for others. Except this time stronger, faster, and harder to kill. I can't remember it all but they were optimizing us, training reflex, pain tolerance, endurance, and something underneath it all"

If pressed, "most of the other subjects failed, most broke, the memories get to unstable"

IF ASKED WHO CONTROLS THE HOLLOW FORGE

"He doesn't run directly because he doesn't need to. He funds what works and destroys the evidence of what doesn't"

WHAT HE KNOWS ABOUT THE SHIPMENT

"It's not a supply convoy, it's a containment move. They call it "The Beast" now. It was part of the same program, early phase, before they figured out the limits. Most of the experiments were built to obey, but not this one. It's always heavily sedated and if it wakes up in the wrong place, It WILL wreak havoc."

PLAYER OPTIONS — “THE PARADE IS MOVING”

1. INTERCEPT THE SHIPMENT CART (Direct Action)

They push through the crowd to reach the sealed wagon.

What this looks like:

- weaving through floats, performers, and guards
- jumping wagons / climbing parade structures
- forcing their way into escort formation

What they gain:

- immediate access to containment cart
- chance to stop release early
- control over when Beast breaks

What they risk:

- escort attention (combat starts early)
 - being isolated inside moving parade
 - triggering Beast panic response early
-

2. DISRUPT THE ESCORT SYSTEM (Strategic Chaos)

Instead of going for the cart, they break the *structure* around it.

Examples:

- collapse parade float bridges
- incite crowd panic at chokepoints
- sabotage signal horns or escort rotations

What they gain:

- escort confusion (cart becomes vulnerable)
- delayed Beast release timing (more prep rounds)

- opportunity for ambush positioning

What they risk:

- uncontrolled civilian panic
 - Beast becomes more aggressive when it senses instability
 - guards stop following rules → full combat escalation
-

3. 🧠 STUDY & TRACK BEFORE ENGAGING (Information First)

They hang back briefly to understand:

- where cart is being swapped
- escort hierarchy
- rune markings / containment seals
- possible weak point in carriage structure

What they gain:

- advantage on Beast containment mechanics
- knowledge of “break trigger” (what releases it fastest)
- potential way to *control direction of Beast release*

What they risk:

- losing optimal interception timing
 - Beast releases into deeper crowd (harder fight)
 - escort reaches transition gate sooner
-

4. 🧑 BLEND INTO PARADE SECURITY (Infiltration Route)

They impersonate:

- guards
- inspectors
- festival wardens
- maintenance crew for floats

What they gain:

- close proximity to cart without suspicion
- ability to manipulate containment checks
- easier access to internal escort chain

What they risk:

- internal verification checks (skill challenge tension)
 - being forced to participate in escort decisions
 - discovery = immediate hostile response
-

5. FORCE EARLY RELEASE (Controlled Chaos Play)

They intentionally trigger the Beast early.

Methods:

- overload containment sigils
- damage cart axle or seals
- create magical interference
- provoke escort into opening cart

What they gain:

- fight happens in more controlled space (before castle gates)
- fewer civilians in later phases
- Beast not fully stabilized yet (more predictable early)

What they risk:

- Beast releases immediately in dense crowd
- escort AND Beast react at once
- higher collateral consequences

Rain continues over broken parade streets.

The crowd is gone now—only wreckage remains.

Somewhere in the distance, the parade still continues... unaware of what just happened here.

Survivor for when they beat the beast:

Example Dialogue Options

“It wasn’t meant to be released here...”

“It was being moved to the Castle facility...”

The float they were using for the parade contains notes:

“Old industrial underlines beneath Wafeld”

06/??/26 Kuba and Nick

Citizens whisper about explosions, missing soldiers, and something that escaped during the parade.

Yet through all of it, Lady Ruth remains calm.

She walks several paces ahead of you both.

Never looking back.

Never asking you to surrender your weapons.

Never treating you like prisoners.

Somehow that feels worse.

Eventually the city streets give way to the towering walls of Castle Wafeld.

Massive gates open before you.

Guards snap to attention as Lady Ruth approaches.

No questions.

No hesitation.

The gates open.

For the first time since arriving in Wafeld...

You enter the castle.

During the Walk

At some point Ruth speaks without turning around.

"Tell me something."

. . .

"Why does every report I've read this month somehow end with dead soldiers, missing shipments, or explosions?"

She continues walking.

"And why do I keep hearing descriptions that sound suspiciously similar to the two of you?"

Let the players answer.

Regardless of what they say:

"Interesting."

And she keeps walking.

The War Room

Lady Ruth leads you deeper into the castle.

Not toward cells.

Not toward a dungeon.

Not even toward a guard barracks.

Instead she stops outside a heavy oak door.

Two guards stand outside.

She dismisses them with a wave.

The room beyond is filled with maps.

Trade routes.

Military reports.

Supply ledgers.

Notes pinned to walls.

Colored strings connect locations across Wafeld and the surrounding countryside.

This isn't an interrogation room.

It's a command center.

Ruth enters.

Drops a stack of reports onto a table.

Takes a seat.

Gestures toward two empty chairs.

Opening the Conversation

"Relax."

"If I intended to arrest you, you'd already be in chains."

She opens a report.

Reads silently.

Makes them wait.

A long uncomfortable pause.

Then:

"Start from the beginning."

"What attacked the convoy?"

Let them explain.

Question One

What attacked the convoy?

Ruth listens carefully.

Not interrupting.

Not arguing.

Just watching.

When they're done:

"And the containment failed how?"

Question Two

The Trap

She's checking whether they know too much.

If they begin describing things only insiders should know:

She narrows her eyes.

Makes a note.

Then asks:

"Interesting."

"And how exactly would a convoy guard know that?"

The Astral Elf Problem

At some point during questioning:

Ruth finally looks directly at Raven.

Long pause.

"You're an astral elf."

Silence.

"There aren't many of you in Wafeld."

Another pause.

"Remind me."

"What unit are you assigned to?"

This isn't an accusation.

It's a test.

She already suspects the answer won't be good.

Building Tension

Eventually Ruth leans back in her chair.

Folds her arms.

"Here's the problem."

She points toward Raven.

"I don't believe your paperwork."

Then toward Igneel.

"I don't believe your story."

Pause.

"But I also don't think you're my enemy."

Another pause.

"Which is inconvenient."

The Reveal

Ruth stands.

Walks toward one of the maps.

Specifically a map of Castle Wafeld.

Her finger taps the castle itself.

"Three months ago workers began disappearing."

"Then guards."

"Then records."

Tap.

"Every trail eventually pointed here."

Tap.

"To this castle."

Silence.

Then:

"Nobody wants to discuss what's beneath it."

Watch player reactions.

The Interruption

A sharp knock at the door.

A nervous servant enters.

Whispers something into Ruth's ear.

Immediately her expression changes.

Not fear.

Concern.

Real concern.

The servant leaves.

Ruth stares at the door.

Then slowly turns back toward the party.

"That's impossible."

Silence.

Then:

"The Beast was recovered."

Pause.

"Alive."

Another pause.

"And whoever took it disappeared."

Ruth looks directly at Raven and Igneel.

Studying them.

Trying to gauge their reaction.

Then hit them with:

"Now."

"Would either of you like to explain why every road I'm following seems to lead back to you?"

And from there you can let the roleplay take over.

Ruth closes the folder.

The room falls silent.

Finally she stands.

"I've heard enough."

She walks toward the door.

"Unfortunately, I have several things I need to verify."

The door opens.

Four guards stand outside.

"Escort them to the east holding wing."

She pauses.

"Politely."

"For now."

The guards move in.

Not drawing weapons.

Not treating them as criminals.

Yet.

The Escort

The guards begin leading Raven and Igneel through the castle.

This gives them time to roleplay.

Maybe whisper.

Maybe plan.

Maybe panic.

Maybe not.

Meanwhile...

Cut briefly.

Raelys

If the rest of the party is nearby:

The rain continues falling as you wait near the castle district.

Hidden among crowds.

Watching.

Waiting.

Then you see movement.

Through one of the upper windows of the castle.

A flash of familiar red scales.

And beside him...

An astral elf.

Raven and Igneel.

Being escorted.

Raelys' Opportunity

Raelys is probably the party member most likely to pull off something ridiculous.

Give her options.

Option 1

Cause a distraction.

Fireball arrow.

Smoke arrow.

Explosive arrow.

Marketplace chaos.

Option 2

Impersonate a messenger.

Convince guards she has urgent orders.

Option 3

Sneak into the castle.

Classic rogue approach.

Option 4

The funniest option.

She notices a supply wagon entering through a side service gate.

The Rescue

My favorite version:

Raelys steals a supply wagon.

Not to drive away.

To drive INTO the castle.

Read Aloud

One moment the courtyard is orderly.

The next...

A wagon comes barreling through the service gate.

Horses screaming.

Crates flying everywhere.

Guards dive out of the way.

Someone yells:

"WHO GAVE HIM A WAGON?!"

Then reveal:

It's Raelys.

The Chaos

Immediately:

- Guards scatter.
- Servants run.
- Horses panic.
- Ruth is elsewhere in the castle.
- Escort formation breaks.

One guard:

"STOP THAT WAGON!"

Another:

"WHICH ONE?!"

The Reunion

Raven and Igneel see the wagon sliding through the courtyard.

Raelys standing in the driver's seat.

Completely committed to the terrible idea.

Raelys

"GET IN!"

No further explanation.

Escape Skill Challenge

Now everyone participates.

Need 3 successes before 2 failures.

Examples:

Raelys

- Vehicle handling
- Animal handling

Raven

- Illusions
- Deception

Igneel

- Athletics
 - Intimidation
-

Ruth's Final Scene

As they escape:

The castle gates begin closing.

Guards rush to intercept.

Then, atop the battlements...

Lady Ruth appears.

Rain falls around her.

She simply watches.

Arms folded.

No shouting.

No threats.

No panic.

Just watching.

As the wagon disappears into the streets.

Because she has now confirmed something important:

These aren't random troublemakers.

They're connected.

And now she starts actively hunting the party.

The Beast

THE BEAST — “DUAL HOUND OF BLACKREACH”

Huge monstrosity (augmented construct), unaligned

A chained experiment bred for pursuit, containment, and extermination. Two heads. One body. Two instincts that do not always agree.

Armor Class

17 (adaptive black-metal hide)

Hit Points

210 (20d10 + 100)

Speed

50 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR 22 (+6)

DEX 16 (+3)

CON 20 (+5)

INT 5 (-3)

WIS 14 (+2)

CHA 8 (-1)

Saving Throws

Str +10, Dex +7, Con +9

Skills

Perception +8, Athletics +10, Survival +6

Damage Resistances

Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing (nonmagical), Lightning

Damage Vulnerabilities

Radiant (while cores are exposed or during Phase Shift windows)

Condition Immunities

Charmed, Frightened, Poisoned

Senses

Darkvision 120 ft., Keen Smell (advantage on Perception relying on scent), Tremorsense 60 ft.

Languages

Understands commands in Common (does not speak)

TRAITS

Two Minds, One Body

The Beast has two independent heads.

- It has advantage on Perception and Insight checks.
- It cannot be surprised.
- Once per round, it can make a **bonus bite attack** (see Multiattack rules).

However:

- If it takes **25+ damage from a single radiant source**, it must succeed DC 15 CON save or become **momentarily desynced** (loses bonus bite next turn).
-

Adaptive Black Metal Hide

Armor hardens as it takes damage:

- 150 HP → AC 18
 - 100 HP → AC 19 + resistance to magical weapon damage
 - 50 HP → enters Overdrive Phase
-

Suppression Instability

At initiative count 20 (after 150 HP threshold), roll d6:

1–2: One head panics → Beast loses bonus bite next round

3–4: Stable

5–6: Beast heals 10 HP and gains +10 ft movement

ACTIONS

Multiattack

The Beast makes:

- 1 Bite (Head A)
- 1 Bite (Head B)
- 1 Claw OR Pounce

Bite (Head A / Head B)

Melee Weapon Attack: +10 to hit, reach 10 ft

Hit: 15 (2d8 + 6) piercing damage

If both bites hit the same target in a round:

- Target must succeed DC 17 STR save or be knocked prone and grappled

Claw

Melee Weapon Attack: +10 to hit

Hit: 16 (2d10 + 6) slashing damage

Target is pushed 10 ft.

Pounce

If Beast moves 20 ft straight toward a creature:

- Target must make DC 17 STR save
- Fail: 18 (4d6 + 4) damage + prone + grappled

Shock Howl (Recharge 5–6)

Both heads scream in sync.

30 ft radius:

- DC 16 CON save

Fail:

- 22 (5d8) thunder damage
- Deafened + frightened until end of next turn

Success:

- Half damage, no condition
-

REACTIONS

Reactive Hide

When hit by critical or radiant damage:

- Reduce damage by 10
 - Attacker takes 8 lightning backlash
-

PHASE SHIFT

Phase 2 — “Desynced Hunt Mode” (100 HP)

The heads stop cooperating perfectly.

Narration:

One head snarls at the other before attacking.

Effects:

- Gains +1 Bite attack (3 total bites per turn max)
- Gains Legendary Resistance (1/day)
- Movement +10 ft

BUT:

- If it takes radiant damage → loses one bite attack next turn
-

Phase 3 — “Predator Break” (50 HP)

Narration:

The Beast no longer fights as a creature. It hunts.

Effects:

- Advantage on all attacks
- Can move through creatures (no collision)
- Bite attacks deal +1d8 damage

BUT:

- Loses coordination → disadvantage on Dexterity saves
 - Vulnerable to environmental control (nets, terrain, illusions, traps)
-

LEGENDARY ACTIONS (3 per round in Phase 2+)

1. Hunt Leap

Moves up to 30 ft and makes a Bite

2. Pack Instinct

One head reacts: grants Beast advantage on next attack

3. Crushing Rush

Moves through a creature (DC 16 STR save or knocked prone + 12 damage)

WEAKNESS SYSTEM — “SYNC CORES”

The Beast has **2 cranial suppression cores**, one per head.

- AC 15

- HP 25 each
- Located behind jaw/neck plating

Destroy effects:

- 1 core destroyed → that head loses Bite attack
 - both destroyed → Beast enters **Break State (stunned 1 round, then enraged but uncontrolled)**
-

FINAL STATE — “UNCHAINED HOUND”

If both cores are destroyed:

- Beast loses structure stability
- Gains +10 ft movement permanently
- Attacks randomly between targets
- Cannot use Shock Howl
- Takes double radiant damage

This is your “finish it or survive it” moment.

LOOT / STORY HOOKS

- Black Metal Cranial Core (Panzuriel resonance item for Khaelen)
- Suppression Collar Fragment (Corvin / Hollow Forge tracking tech)
- Beast Conditioning Sigil (Saxson control mechanism key)

Magic Item List

Bracers of Archery Δ

Wondrous Item, uncommon (requires attunement)

While wearing these bracers, you have proficiency with the Longbow and Shortbow, and you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls made with such weapons.

Notes: Proficiency: Longbow, Proficiency: Shortbow, Damage: Shortbow, Damage: Longbow, Damage, Buff, Combat, Wristwear

Item Tags: DAMAGE BUFF COMBAT WRISTWEAR

Dungeon Master's Guide, pg. 156



Nature's Mantle

Professor Orb

Prologue

Echo of Quinlan, Adjudicator of the Lattice

Medium construct (manifested ideal), lawful neutral

Armor Class 17 (judgment plate)

Hit Points 165 (16d8 + 64)

Speed 30 ft.

STR 16 (+3)

DEX 12 (+1)

CON 18 (+4)

INT 14 (+2)

WIS 16 (+3)

CHA 14 (+2)

Saving Throws Wis +7, Con +8

Skills Insight +7, Persuasion +6, Athletics +7

Damage Resistances radiant, psychic

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Celestial

Challenge CR 6 (2,300 XP)

(Appropriate solo boss for level 5 party)

TRAITS

Judgment Made Manifest

The Echo cannot be surprised. Creatures within 10 feet of the Echo cannot gain advantage on attack rolls.

Legendary Resistance (1/Day)

If the Echo fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Unyielding Doctrine

The Echo has advantage on saving throws against spells or effects that would move it against its will or restrain it.

Measured Response

The Echo never makes opportunity attacks. It only strikes when judgment demands it.

ACTIONS

Multiattack

The Echo makes **two Judgment Blade attacks**.

Judgment Blade

Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target

Hit: 9 (1d8 + 5) slashing damage + 7 (2d6) radiant damage

If this attack reduces a creature to 0 hit points, the creature is **stable** instead of unconscious.

Pronouncement of Fault (Recharge 5–6)

The Echo targets one creature it can see within 30 feet.

The target must succeed on a **DC 15 Wisdom saving throw** or:

- Have disadvantage on its next attack roll or saving throw
- Lose any advantage it currently has

On a success, the target gains advantage on its next saving throw.

Stay Your Hand

The Echo raises its blade and issues a command.

Each creature of the Echo's choice within 15 feet must succeed on a **DC 15 Wisdom saving throw** or be **restrained** until the end of its next turn as radiant chains briefly bind them.

REACTIONS

Rebuke Excess

When a creature within 10 feet gains advantage on a roll, the Echo can use its reaction to negate that advantage.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

(The Echo can take 2 legendary actions per round, only one at a time, at the end of another creature's turn.)

Measured Step

The Echo moves up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Judging Glance

One creature the Echo can see must succeed on a **DC 15 Wisdom saving throw** or have disadvantage on its next roll.

ALTERNATE VICTORY CONDITIONS (CRITICAL TO THE STORY)

The Echo **immediately dissipates** (no death animation, no hostility) if **any one** of the following occurs:

1. The Echo is reduced below **30 hit points**
2. A PC uses an action to make a **DC 15 Persuasion or Insight check** explaining *why restraint matters more than certainty*
3. The **Locket of Binding** is used successfully (Arcana or Religion DC 14)
4. A PC willingly forfeits their action for a round to accept judgment

When this happens, the Echo says:

“Judgment... satisfied.”

Encounter Ideas

Master forger

Cooking tournament

Fishing tournament

Destroying/stealing illicit goods

Traveling merchant front (human smugglers)

“Witch” burning (appease an old god)

Traveling merchant and his circus of dangerous creatures (black pudding, gelatinous cube,

Backwater tatoos shop (cursed tattoos offered) (rare tattoos included) (Ghost step tattoo)

The hungry mug inn (check saved dnd ig)

Gladiator fight

Wandering oracle (prophecies)

Carnival games <https://youtube.com/shorts/U1xLLcMKgHE?si=ZzMh0CRAbgaEgIMu>

<https://youtube.com/shorts/6nbNtTLdMGE?si=nGC-vWfU9IkZyQYx>

Pimp Jew Illegal Items

Lockless key
Mage binder cuffs
Glassfang dagger
Widows Ring
Magic arrow
Astral longshot rifle
Scroll of Modify Memory (illegal in the hands of
Bottled Planatar Sigh
Stolen Aboleth Eyeball
The Bone Charter
The Condemned Verdict

NPCS

ARMOR EVO

CURRENT CHAOS POINTS: 1

Chaos Points

Track **Chaos Points (CP)**.

Each significant piece of black metal absorbed grants:

+1 Chaos Point

Major artifacts:

+2 to +5 Chaos Points

The armor grows stronger at specific thresholds.

But Panzuriel's influence grows with it.

Tier 0 — Dormant

(0 CP)

Current state.

+3 Plate Armor

Whispers occasionally.

No mechanical downside.

Tier 1 — Awakened

(3 CP)

The armor begins responding to danger.

Benefits

- Gain Resistance to Psychic Damage.
- Once per Long Rest:
 - Add 1d8 Chaos Damage to a weapon attack.

Drawback

Whenever reduced below half HP:

DC 10 Wisdom Save.

Failure:

The armor whispers violent suggestions.

Roleplay only.

No loss of control.

Tier 2 — Hungry

(6 CP)

The armor starts moving slightly on its own.

Benefits

- +10 movement speed.
- Critical hits deal an additional 1d8 damage.
- Gain Darkvision 60 ft if you don't have it.

Drawback

Whenever combat begins:

DC 12 Wisdom Save.

Failure:

Armor chooses a "worthy foe."

Must attack that foe if possible.

Not mind control.

Just compulsion.

Tier 3 — Ascendant

(10 CP)

Panzuriel begins noticing Khaelen directly.

Benefits

- Gain resistance to Necrotic and Psychic damage.
- Chaos Smite:
Once per Long Rest:
Add 4d8 Force damage to a melee attack.

Drawback

Whenever Khaelen rolls a Natural 1:

Roll a Chaos Surge.

d6	Effect
1	Attack nearest creature
2	Laugh uncontrollably
3	Teleport 30 feet randomly
4	Weapon attack gains advantage but must be used immediately
5	Eyes glow black, intimidation advantage
6	No effect

Tier 4 — Herald of Chaos

(15 CP)

The armor has become a relic of Panzuriel.

Benefits

- Gain a flying speed equal to walking speed for 1 minute (1/LR).
- Gain immunity to being frightened.
- Chaos Damage becomes 2d8.

Drawback

Every Long Rest:

DC 15 Wisdom Save.

Failure:

Panzuriel influences Khaelen's dreams.

Gain one random flaw until next long rest.

Examples:

- "Rules are suggestions."
- "Violence solves this."
- "The strongest should rule."

Tier 5 — Avatar Candidate

(20+ CP)

At this point the armor is no longer pretending.

Benefits

- Strength becomes 22.

- Gain Resistance to all non-magical damage.
- Chaos Smite becomes 6d8.

Drawback

Every time Khaelen falls unconscious:

DC 18 Wisdom Save.

Failure:

Panzuriel temporarily takes control.

Possession System

This should be rare.

Extremely rare.

When it happens:

The DM controls Khaelen for 1d4 rounds.

Panzuriel is not trying to kill allies.

He's trying to create chaos.

Examples:

- Release prisoners.
- Destroy important objects.
- Burn evidence.
- Start fights.
- Reveal secrets.

Things that make situations worse.

Black Metal Absorption

The armor can consume:

- Dark Metal Knight armor
- Hollow Forge alloys
- Corrupted constructs
- Butcherer creations
- Chaos relics

Each absorption should be a scene.

Example:

The metal twists.

Flows.

The armor pulls it inward.

Like liquid being drawn into a wound.

For a moment the helmet turns toward you.

Not Khaelen.

You.

The player.

The eye slits glow crimson.

A low voice echoes:

"More."

Then the glow fades.

GODS/DEITIES

Name	Description & Domain	Relations
Panzurriel	God of Chaos - chaos, darkness, drow, evil, entropy, madness	Eternal Enemy - Primus - Their conflict is the oldest war Chaos vs Order. Every act of creation by Primus is an affront
Nyrissa	God of Fate - Fate, Destiny, Divination, the Future, and Honesty.	https://homebrewery.naturalcrit.com/share/18OslypOkqxljco0aul_-YuYkYsSIVXazDhShRkSortez
Primus	God of Order, Law, Structure, Inevitability, and Mathematics	
Myrkul	God of Death, Endings, Undeath, Grief, Memory of the Dead	
Asgorath	Creator of Dragons, Creation, Primordial Power, Elemental Chaos, Ancient Memory	
Tymora	God of Luck, Good Fortune, Skill and Victory -	
Beshaba	God of Bad Luck, Accidents, Misfortune, and Random Mischief -	
Sehanine Moonbow	Goddess of moon, dreams, mysteries, secrets, travel/journeys -	At first, Sehanine shouldn't appear as a goddess. She should appear as a mystery. Early Signs Raven begins having unusual dreams. Not commands. Not prophecies. Dreams. Moonlit roads. Silver forests. A distant figure walking ahead. Pages turning in an unseen journal. Stars reflected in calm water. A white owl watching silently from a tree branch.

St. Gaed	Deity - Followers of St. Gaed seek the truth hidden in people's hearts and are quick to find conspiracies, secret orders, and cults.	
Bahamut	God of Justice, Honor, Protection	
Melora	Goddess of Nature, Wilderness, Oceans	
Moradin	God of Forge, Creation, Family, Endurance	
Velkros	God of Knowledge, Memory, Secrets of the Mind, and Lost History	

FACTIONS

WAFELD

Lord Saxton's Rule		
Thieves Guild		
Butcher		

Cities & Capitals

Thoggarde

- **Summary:** Perched on the western shores of Alverra, across the sea from Wafeld and beneath the shadow of the northern mountains, **Thoggarde** is a bustling port city built around freedom, trade, and exploration. The city serves as the final stop for adventurers seeking the legendary Astral Gate, a mysterious portal hidden in the mountains beyond.

Unlike many cities in Alverra, newcomers are welcomed regardless of their origin, status, or past. Exiles, merchants, explorers, scholars, and wanderers all find a home in Thoggarde. The city is known for its lively taverns, diverse population, and culture of acceptance, earning it the nickname:

"The City of Second Chances."

- **Culture**

Dream Festivals

During the brightest full moon of the year:

Citizens gather on rooftops and beaches.

Lanterns are released into the sky.

Stories are shared.

Journeys are celebrated.

Future adventures are planned.

The event is called:

The Night of Silver Dreams

- **Power in the Overarching World**

While Wafeld controls wealth and Aetheris controls magical knowledge, Thoggarde controls something equally valuable:

Access

Every expedition heading toward:

- The Astral Gate
- The Northern Mountains
- Khaz-Durak
- Ancient ruins beyond the frontier

must pass through Thoggarde.

As a result:

- Explorers spend fortunes here.
- Scholars establish research lodges here.
- Mercenary companies recruit here.
- Dwarven traders from Khaz-Durak regularly visit.

Many of the world's greatest discoveries began in a tavern or guildhall in Thoggarde.

Though not politically powerful, the city is incredibly influential because information flows through it constantly.

● Religion in Thoggarde

The Silver Path

While people in Thoggarde worship many gods, **Sehanine Moonbow** is by far the most beloved deity in the city.

To the people of Thoggarde, she is known as:

The Lady of the Silver Path

The Dreaming Wanderer

Keeper of Hidden Roads

Travelers often say:

"The moon shines on every road."

Meaning no matter how lost someone becomes, Sehanine can still guide them.

Many priests believe the Astral Gate is sacred to Sehanine.

Not because she created it.

Because it represents what she values most:

A path into the unknown.

As a result:

Pilgrims frequently travel to Thoggarde seeking enlightenment.

Many never attempt the gate itself.

Simply standing beneath the stars and wondering what lies beyond is enough.

● History

Over 800 years ago, an archmage named **Aldren Thorne** discovered evidence of a stable passage leading toward the Astral Plane.

Fearing misuse, he established a series of magical trials and safeguards throughout the mountains.

According to official records, these tests were designed to ensure only worthy seekers could approach the Astral Gate.

Most citizens don't believe that story.

The popular belief is far more dramatic:

The Archmage didn't build the defenses.

He found them.

Many locals believe the Astral Gate predates civilization itself and is protected by primordial forces older than the gods.

No evidence has ever confirmed either theory.

The debate continues to this day.